



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

CONTENTS

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT— [Col. 1]

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE— [Col. 8]

PAPERS—

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Meteorological Agency for the year 2024— [Col. 44]
- (b) Report of the Finance Committee on the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025— [Col. 44]
- (c) Report of the House Committee on an orientation workshop on the status of facilities and services available to Members of Parliament for the smooth discharge of their mandates— [Col. 46]

BILLS — SECOND READING

- (a) Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025— [Col. 57]
- (b) National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025— [Col. 88]

BILLS — THIRD READING

- (a) Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025— [Col. 45]
- (b) Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025— [Col. 82]

BILLS — CONSIDERATION STAGE

- (a) Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025— [Col. 81]
- (b) National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025— [Col. 119]

STATEMENTS—

- (a) Inscription of Highlife Music— [Col. 47]
- (b) Upholding the Rule of Law and Due Process in Ghana's Democratic System— [Col. 53]

ADJOURNMENT— [Col. 128]

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Friday, 12th December, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 1:34 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, in the absence of the Message from the President and Formal Communication by the Speaker, may we go straight ahead to take the item numbered 5, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS
AND THE
OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have before us the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 11th December, 2025.

Page 1...8— Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Ahmed Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, on the page numbered 7, my name, Ibrahim Ahmed is written. I was here yesterday and I have been marked absent; the same was done two days ago.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, he has been marked absent on the item numbered 23. Table, kindly take note.

Page 8...11— Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie, you have the floor.

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

May I respectfully invite you to the item numbered 8(b). May we delete the word “Deputy” and insert the word “Minister.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 13...14— Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Afriyie: On the page numbered 13, under the Motion 17, we need to insert the word “seconded” before the sentence, which reads “...by the Chairman of the Committee...”. That is the Motion moved by the Minister for Transport, Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari. So, we should insert the word “and seconded by”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I have indicated in this House over and over that, at Second Reading, we do not second the Motion. We present the Committee's Report. So, whatever is captured here is the correct position. There is no need indicating that the Motion is seconded. If you look at the marginal note, it reads:

“The Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill, 2025, *accordingly* read a *second* time.”

So, at the Second Reading, we do not second. Please, let us all take note.

Page 14...16—

Yes, Prof Kingsley?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I have a small observation on the page numbered 11. Even though it is very minor, probably, I would seek your guidance on that. If we look at the item numbered 11, under the title “MOTION”, the Committee on Public Administration and State Interest— If we look at Order 207(x), the word “Interests” has an “s” at the end of the word which makes it plural. But, if we turn to Order 261, the singular form is captured.

Looking at the *Votes and Proceedings*, the singular version is what is captured. I mean, it conforms to the Order. But my point is that the name of the Committee is at one point, plural and another singular. In this, it is only the singular form that is captured. But there is conflict in the Standing Orders regarding 207(x) and 260(1).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, we can reconcile. But, for me, guided by the Interpretation Act, singular means plural. So, Table Office should do the reconciliation.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Vincent Assafuah: Mr Speaker, with your leave, let me bring you back to the page numbered 6. I have been marked absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Assafuah, you are taking me far back.

Mr Assafuah: That is why I respectfully asked that I might do so with your leave.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, were you present?

Mr Assafuah: Yes, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 16— Yes, Hon Member?

Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukutor: Mr Speaker, I need your guidance on this, please. I usually hear you say that the draftsmen should take note. On the page numbered 16, it reads, “The Hon First Deputy Speaker directed the draftsperson... ”.

I want your guidance on this. I just heard you say singular means plural.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it depends on whoever is at the Chamber as the draftsperson. So, at that material moment, I may say the draftsmen, when those who are here are all men. But, if those who are here are a mixture of males and females, I may say draftspersons or draftsperson, since singular means plural.

Going forward, I think we should use the word draftsperson, so that we will be gender neutral. I know Hajia Laadi is happy because going forward, I will be gender neutral.

1:44 p.m.

Ing Surv Lukutor: Mr Speaker, it is really not about the gender aspect of it. It is about whether it is one person or a group of people.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, if one person is sitting down as a draftperson, how do you want me to put it? If two or more are sitting down as draftpersons, how do you want to put it? Because they sit on my far right, and I see them.

Ing Surv Lukutor: So, in this case, was it just one person?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, probably. So, I will be using the terminology draftperson going forward.

Page 17... 28 —

Hon Members, page 27; “The Hon First Deputy Speaker directed the draft person to provide a definition for learners with special needs”

The draft person accordingly provided the following definition for learners with special needs.

“Learners with special needs means learners who require specialised accommodation, support, or services that are not usually provided for other

learners due to physical, mental, intellectual, or sensory impairments”

This definition is for your consideration.

Hon Members, if there are no views, we need to adopt that particular definition, and it is this definition that will appear in the interpretation column of the Bill that will come before us. In the absence of any contrary view, we will adopt the definition together with the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, in adopting it, I was just wondering, in between intellectual or all, but I am consulting with a medical doctor—Emotional, autistic patient, how do we describe them? It is not emotional? I thought emotional would have come before sensory impairment, but I am consulting with a doctor and it will satisfy what was raised by the Deputy Leader, Hon Ahmed and our Colleagues.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 11th December, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, I also have in my hand the *Official Report* of Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025, for your correction.

[No correction was made to the *Official Report* of Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, with your indulgence, I acknowledge the presence of students from Little Angel Montessori, led by Priscilla Owusu-Amoaku, headmistress. They are from Weija Gbawe. Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, please take note. Your students are here, and they are 63 in number.

[Students from Little Angel Montessori were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have students from Sogakope Senior High School, led by Sebastian Ashiagbor, a teacher. They are from South Tongu, they number 67. Hon Member for South Tongu, you may be on your feet for your students to see, and thereafter you are expected to do the needful.

[Students from Sogakope Senior High School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we also have students from Alavanyo Senior High Technical School, led by Roland Katapu, chaperone and they are from Hohoe Constituency. They number 68.

[Students from Alavanyo Senior High Technical were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I hope Hon Thomas WorlanyoTsekpo is—

Yes, Hon Member for Afadjato South?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, he is my neighbour and he is on an assignment

somewhere, so I will be doing the needful on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, then you are tasked with that responsibility. Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome our dear students to the Parliament of Ghana, and wish them a very fruitful visit to Parliament. Once again, you are most welcome.

Hon Majority Leader, at this point, any indication?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, we would take the Business Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement. I will call on the Chairperson of the Business Committee, Hon Majority Leader and Leader of Government Business.

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairperson of the Business Committee/Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to present the Business Statement for the week ending Friday, December 19th, 2025. Your Committee met on Thursday, December 11, 2025, and arranged the Business as follows:

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

No. of Question(s)

i. Minister for Food and Agriculture	6
ii. Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms	3
iii. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
iv. Minister of State in Charge of Government Communications	2
v. Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment	3
vi. Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs	9
vii. Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry	4
viii. Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts	4
Total Number of Questions	<u>41</u>

Mr Speaker, in all, eight (8) Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to Forty-One (41) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – 0; ii. Oral – 41

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policies. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Standing Order 93 of Parliament.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 159 of Parliament, Bills may be presented to the House for First

Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Standing Order 160 of Parliament.

Pursuant to Standing Order 97 of Parliament, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions, may be debated, and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the Week.

Committee Reports on Referrals

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee acknowledges the hard work of

Committees for promptly presenting reports on the Budget Estimates. The Committee continues to urge Chairpersons of Committees to treat all pending referrals with the urgency deserved and report on same expeditiously.

Adjournment of the House

Mr Speaker, the House is expected to adjourn *sine die* on 19th December, 2025. In this regard, the Business Committee encourages Hon Members to continue to devote themselves to the Business of the House as proposed.

The Business Committee takes this opportunity to commend the Speaker, Deputy Speakers, and all Hon Members for the sacrifice and devotion to the Business of the House throughout the Meeting. The Committee looks forward to a smooth discharge of the Business proposed for the last week of the Meeting before the House adjourns *sine die*.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 216 (2) of Parliament and subject to Standing Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the Week.

1:54 p.m.

Tuesday, 16th December, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Questions

***433. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what measures are being taken to control pests and diseases in crops and livestock.

***428. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what initiatives have been implemented to boost agricultural production and increase farmers' income.

***431. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture how the Government is strengthening extension services to provide farmers with information on best practices.

***465. Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what the Ministry intends to do to address the volatility of the world market prices of cashew and its impacts on farmgate prices and exports.

***528. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the plans to enhance the poultry value chain from production to processing and value addition, marketing and distribution and consumption and demand.

***530. Mr Anthony Mmieh (Odotobri):** To ask the Minister Food and Agriculture what interventions the Ministry is undertaking to ensure fair and equitable distribution of food nationwide

in the light of the increasing cost of foodstuff across the country especially in mining communities.

***236. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu):** To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms what specific reforms the Ministry is implementing to improve efficiency, transparency and accountability.

***249. Mr Samuel Awuku (Akwapim North):** To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms what steps are being taken to digitise public services and reduce bureaucratic delays at key Government agencies.

***500. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reform how the Public Records and Archives Administration Department (PRAAD)'s digitisation of 55,259 archival sheets and disposal of 8,540 boxes are improving records management, efficiency and what resources have been allocated for further digitisation in 2025.

Statements

- (a) **Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe (Ada):** To make a Statement on domestic violence.
- (b) **Ms Helen Adjoa Ntoso (Krachi West):** To make a Statement on Volta Lake Disaster.
- (c) **Mrs Joycelyn Quashie (North Dayi):** To make a Statement on the

2025 International Day for the Elimination of Violence Against Women.

- (d) **Mrs Ernestina Ofori Dangbey (Agona West):** To make a Statement on the commemoration of the International Day for the Elimination of Violence Against Women.
- (e) **Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (Garu):** To make a Statement on closing the Physician Gap in Ghana—Global Perspectives and Strategic Options.
- (f) **Mrs Dr Stephen Amoah (Nhyiaeso):** To make a Statement on making Entrepreneurship part of Ghana's Basic and SHS Academic Curricula.
- (g) **Ms Dorcas Afo Toffey (Jomoro):** To make a Statement on addressing Violence against Women and Girls.
- (h) **Mr Solomon Kuyon (Krachi Nchumuru):** To make a Statement on the urgent need for a National Youth Development Fund.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Proposed Formula for Distributing the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) for the Year 2026.
- (b) Proposed Formula for Distributing the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the Year 2026.
- (c) Proposed Formula for Distributing the National Health Insurance Fund for the year 2026.

- (d) Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2026.
- (e) Report of the Committee on Education on the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025.
- (f) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025.
- (g) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Governance Advisory Council Bill, 2025.
- (h) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Interstate Succession Bill, 2025.
- (i) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.
- (j) Report of the Finance Committee on the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025.

Presentation and First Reading of Bills

- Appropriations (No. 2) Bill, 2025

Motions

- (a) Second Reading of Bills

- Appropriations (No.2) Bill, 2025.
- Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025
- Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025
- 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025
- Governance Advisory Council Bill, 2025
- Interstate Succession Bill, 2025
- Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025
- Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025

Committee Sitings

Wednesday, 17th December, 2025

Roll Call

Questions

***377. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan):**

To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when work will commence on the following areas in the Kadjebi District, since the Feeder Department completed the survey and mapping years ago: (i) Dodi-Papase to Dodo-Pepesu (ii) Dodo-Amanfrom to Daapa Junction (iii) Asato to Wawaso (iv) Koto-Nkwanta to Titiaka (v) Koto-Nkwanta to Sabram

***453. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan)**

To ask the Minister for Roads and

Highways when the following roads will be fixed: (i) Dodo – Olobi to Okrakrom (Koru) (ii) Akposokodzi Township Kadjebi road.

***455. Mr Sanja Nanja (Atebubu/Amantin):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways what immediate measures the Ministry is implementing to fix the potholes on the Amantin and the Yeji stretch of the Kumasi-Yeji Highway to prevent further deterioration of the road.

***380. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Government is going to renovate the Sogakope Bridge (Lower Volta Bridge), especially the expansion gaps and the metal railings.

***381. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of work on the Agave-Afedume road and when work will commence on site.

***476. Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of the Ejisu-Onwe-Assieninpong-Kwaso road in the Ejisu Constituency and when work will resume to complete the road.

***512. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will resume and be completed (i) Maakro – Agogo- Twedie (ii) Supreme Saviour – Canaan.

***516. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will resume and be completed: (i) Bosankro Junction – Bosankro (ii) Akuapim Junction – Akuapim.

***517. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction works will resume on the following roads: (i) Wiosu – Amanchia (ii) Nkawie – Nkran Foase (iii) Ntabanum Junction – Ntabanum.

***515. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor for the Community 9 Light Industrial Area Road network will return to site.

***535. Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri):** To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Government Communications the full details of the Government Advisory Council, which was set up upon the invitation of the President to representatives of Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) in Ghana, and what this auxiliary body is costing the taxpayer.

***96. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To ask the Minister of State in charge of Government Communication the total cost of all committees formed by the President and Ministers and the sources of funds since the expenditure was not included in the first-quarter budget approved by Parliament.

***470. Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what proactive measures the Ministry is taking on labour upheavals that have become rife lately in the country.

***503. Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what the Ministry is using to track employment growth and if these targets are being met.

***504. Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what is being done to improve occupational health and safety standards, especially in high-risk industries like construction and mining.

Statements

(a) **Mr Eric Edem Agbana (Ketu North):** To make a Statement on population and development: Shaping Ghana's Development.

(b) **Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (Upper Manya Krobo):** To make a Statement on the Commemoration of the Annual Ngmayem Festival Celebrated by the Chiefs and People of Manya Kloe Traditional Area, to be Held from 27th October to 1st of November.

(c) **Ms Laurette Korkor Asante (Atiwa West):** To make a Statement on Emergency Care in Ghana; A Lack Thereof.

(d) **Mr Ntebe Ayo William (Tatale-Sanguli):** To make a Statement on the poor demarcation of electoral boundaries and overcrowded polling stations as root causes of election disputes in Ghana.

(e) **Dr Mahama Tiah Abdul-Kabiru (Walewale):** To make a Statement on the decline of youth financing from the District Assembly Common Fund (DACF) to the National Youth Authority (NYA) and the Youth Employment Agency (YEA).

(f) **Mr Davis Ansah Opoku (Mpreaso) and Mr Abed-Nego Bandim (Bunkprugu):** To make a joint Statement on strengthening key institutions to drive Ghana's Digital Transformation and Inclusion: Lessons from participating in the GIZ-Supported Tech Policy Fellowship.

(g) **Mr Issah Atta (Sagnarigu):** To make a Statement on opportunities for trade facilitation within and among African countries: challenges, weaknesses, and the way forward.

(h) **Ms Dorcas Afo Toffey (Jomoro):** To make a Statement on the Economic Empowerment and Financial Literacy of Women.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for Distributing the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) for the Year 2026.
- (b) Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for Distributing the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the Year 2026.
- (c) Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for Distributing the National Health Insurance Fund for the year 2026.

Motions

- (a) That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for Distributing the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) for the Year 2026.
- (b) That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for the Distribution of the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the Year 2026.
- (c) That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for Distributing the National Health Insurance Fund for the year 2026.
- (d) Third Reading of Bills

- Appropriations (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Consideration Stage of Bills

- Appropriations (No.2) Bill, 2025.
- Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025.
- Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025.
- Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025.

Committee Sitzings

- *COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE* - To consider the proposed formula for the distribution of the District Assemblies Common Fund, National Health Insurance Fund and the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the year 2026.

Thursday, 18th December, 2025

Roll Call

Questions

***199. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs the plans of the Ministry for the rebuilding of the Klo-Agogo and the Nkrakan markets in Yilo Krobo Constituency.

***313. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for

Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs the total number of churches in the country and the number of them that are registered.

***314. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs how the Ministry intends to promote productive working relationship between Members of Parliament and the Metropolitan, Municipal and District Chief Executives to ensure effective governance in the various local assemblies.

***364. Mr Kwame Kodua Appiah (Fanteakwa North):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs the measures implemented for the final completion of the Begoro Central Market.

***365. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs the plans of the Ministry to upgrade the Assemblies which were conferred with Municipal/Metropolitan status last year and when the Legislative Instrument will be passed for the Assemblies to be inaugurated.

***395. Mr Daniel Dung Mahama (Talensi):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Regional Affairs when the Upper East Region will receive the Toyota Hilux that were distributed to the other regions in 2024.

***526. Mr Martin Adjei-Mensah Korsah (Techiman South):** To ask the

Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs whether the reports of DRIP machines being used at Galamsey Sites have come to his attention, and what the Ministry is doing to ensure accountability in the use of the said machines.

***436. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious affairs what steps are being implemented to ensure the timely completion of 618 infrastructure projects and 60 markets under the Gulf of Guinea Social Cohesion (SOCO) Project.

***438. Mr Charles Owiredi (Abirem):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs to provide an update on the elevation of the Birim North District Assembly to a municipal status by President Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo Addo on 7th November, 2024.

***286. Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the status of the Komenda Sugar Factory.

***315. Mr Michael Okyere Baafi (New Juaben South):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the status of the vehicle component manufacturing policy.

***316 Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the specific interventions the Ministry has taken to stimulate domestic production,

increase export volumes and add value to our products to boost trade earnings.

***401. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang – Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the plans of the Ministry to increase exports to take advantage of the current cedi performance as well as increase the share of the trade sector to Ghana's GDP.

***367. Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the measures the Ministry is implementing to prevent the desecration of the Independence Arc, Kwame Nkrumah Mausoleum and other sacred national monuments by same-sex couples and LGBTQ+ activists.

***544. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the plans of the Ministry to expand employment to the indigenes in Kakum National Park enclave who have been marginalised from employment opportunities in the Constituency.

***577. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts how the Ministry plans to implement the Black Star experience in 2025 and what institutional partnerships and private sector collaborations are being established to ensure its success as a diaspora tourism brand.

***595. Mr Felix Akwetey Okle (Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfro):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the

plans of the Ministry to develop the Solo Monkey Forest in Bortianor to expand the tourism industry for economic development and sustainable ecological management.

Statements

(a) **Mr Charles Asiedu (Tano South):** To make a Statement on the Urgent need to revitalise the Ghana Cylinder Manufacturing Company Limited.

(b) **Mr Eric Edem Agbana (Ketu North):** To make a Statement on the need to upgrade the Ohawu Agricultural College into a fully-fledged Agricultural University.

(c) **Mr Sebastian Deh (Kpando):** To make a Statement on supporting Smallholder Farmers in Ghana- The role of Financial inclusion with tailor-made Innovative Financial Products.

(d) **Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To make a Statement on the need to prioritise the completion and optimal utilisation of existing Sports Infrastructure before initiating New Projects.

(e) **Mr Richmond Edem Kofi Kpotosu (Ho Central):** To make a Statement on the UHAS Leads Ghana in Global Impact Rankings- A Beacon of Health, Innovation and Development.

(f) **Mr Joseph Kwame Kumah (Kintampo North):** To make a Statement on the urgent call to establish a Health Security Fund for Ghana.

(g) **Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (Evalue Ajomoro Gwira):** To make a Statement on the State of Housing in Ghana and the need for a National Affordable Housing Fund Act.

(h) **Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (Offinso North):** To make a Statement on the persistent and escalating threat of Highway Robbery on our roads in Ghana.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

(a) Third Reading of Bills

- Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025
- Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025
- Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025

Committee Sittings

Friday, 19th December, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

(a) **Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu):** To make a Statement on the deplorable condition of roads in the Ejisu Constituency.

(b) **Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (Upper Manya Krobo):** To make a Statement on the Overflow of River Klum on the Asesewa-Abuorso road and its impact on commuters.

(c) **Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To make a Statement on the urgent need to prioritise and invest in Ghana's Boxing.

(d) **Mr Emmanuel Tobbin (Anyaa Sowutuom):** To make a Statement on Broken Traffic Lights and Pedestrian Safety in Ghana.

(e) **Mr. Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira):** To make a Statement on the importance of connecting entrepreneurs in Micro, Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises landscape in Ghana.

(f) **Mr Kweku Asante-Boateng (Asante Akim South):** To make a Statement on tragic road accident around Juaso on the Accra-Kumasi Highway.

(g) **Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East):** To make a Statement on the Challenges of the Cashew Industry in Ghana.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee Sittings

THE HOUSE EXPECTED TO ADJOURN *SINE DIE*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement is ably presented. It is now for Hon Members to comment.

Hon Members, we welcome comments on the Business Statement starting from Mr Ekow Assafuah.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I have in my hands the Business Statement for last two weeks and last week. I had two Questions, and those two Questions cannot be found in the Business Statement today, yet it was not taken. Two new Questions that are filed have been programmed to be taken next week, as to whether it is going to be taken or not, I cannot really be sure. I say so because, at least for the past one month, this is how the Business of the House has been. There are a number of Questions and a number of Statements that have been advertised for more than a month, and it has not been taken. So, I will plead with the Hon Majority Leader to look at that.

Secondly, there is another important public issue. Mr Speaker, yesterday I saw a letter from the Presidency, which was to the effect that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I have cause to admonish that, going by the rules that govern the House, the Business Statement is a Statement, and Statement time is Statement time. It is Statement time that allows you to come under Standing Order 93 to draw the attention of the House to a matter of urgent public importance. But when we are considering a Business Statement, it should strictly be a Business Statement, unless the rules that govern the House points to the contrary.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, respectfully, this is my fifth year in this House. There are times that we are given an opportunity to suggest to the Hon Majority Leader by way of amending the Business Statement, to bring an Hon Minister or an Independent Constitutional Body to this House to answer Questions that are of public importance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I also believe strongly that last week, the Hon Majority Leader and Leader of Government Business in a very clear and certain words, very unambiguous in nature, that if you want an Independent Constitutional Body or an Hon Minister to be brought to this particular House, as an Hon Member of Parliament, the rules are clear as to what you are supposed to do. That was clear for all us to understand.

So, the Hon Majority Leader will ask that you are asking him to bring the Hon Minister to come and respond to an issue. Is that the means known to the rules by

which the Hon Minister will come and respond to the issue and do a briefing?

So, the rules are clear. If you want the Hon Minister to come urgently, the rules guide you as to what you should do. But it is not *suo moto* that the Business Committee would programme an Hon Minister to come and respond to an issue.

So, let us use the rules and take advantage of the rules, and we will not have a problem.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I agree with you, but with the greatest of respect, that is why, when I started, I made mention of the fact that this is my fifth year in the House. While I agree that the rules allow for an Hon Member who believes that when there is an issue for us to deal with, will bring the Hon Minister to this Floor.

Mr Speaker, in my five years in this House, we have always allowed Hon Members to appeal to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, in order to cut a long story short, pick up the Standing Orders and point at the circumstances that allow me to order the Business Statement to be varied by bringing an Hon Member, Hon Minister or independent constitutional bodies to come when commenting on a Business Statement.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, my point is a very simple one, and if you would indulge me, with the greatest of respect—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, my point is also a very simple one. Too much of everything is bad. I think once the House came to a conclusion that we should apply the rules, the Business Statement is the Business Statement. I would take a comment on the Business Statement. If it is not a comment on the Business Statement, then I will plead with you to resume your seat. But if it is a comment, go ahead and make your comment on the Business Statement.

2:04 p.m.

Mr Assafuah: All right, I will go to my next point. Just about two weeks ago, it was agreed in this House, by way of the Business Statement, that the Majority Leader would call on the Minister for Education to respond to the woeful performance of our young ones in the West African Senior Secondary Schools Examination (WASSCE). The Majority Leader promised he would look into it to ensure it is programmed for the Minister for Education to come to the Floor to address the matter. As we speak, that matter has not been discussed. If possible, I will appeal to the Majority Leader to programme time for the Minister for Education to come to the House to address it. Respectfully, my next point has nothing to do with the Business Statement, but it is very important.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, if it has nothing to do with the Business Statement, with all due respect, for today, kindly resume your seat.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, we have been restricted regarding how to handle the Business Statement; that is not good, but it is all right. However, on the Business Statement, pages 6 and 7, two of my Questions were advertised today to be answered by the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs and the Minister for Trade, Industry and Agribusiness. These two Questions have been scheduled time and time again, but I am unable to ask them and they have been rescheduled for next week. What is the guarantee that next week the same Questions that have been programmed on three different occasions will be answered? For me, it is worrying that I prepare to come and ask Questions, only to be dodged.

I am hoping that today they will be handled, but I am not convinced because these same Questions have been reprogrammed for next week. I am referring to Questions numbered 313 and 316. My major concern has to do with Question 313. Last week, I asked three related Questions regarding our religious institutions: their number and how many are registered. The week prior to programming the first one on shrines, two of them, including the one on mosques, had been programmed on the Business Statements. Sadly, only one, the one on shrines, came. Now, assuming I am not able to ask this Question today, next week is about the churches. Where is the Question on mosques? My point is that when Questions are related, intuitively, it is appropriate to table them or programme them at the same time to make more meaning.

Now, the one on mosques has been left out. How will the public even see the essence and relevance of the question? So, my suggestion is that such Questions might be programmed together. Otherwise, I would not be happy leaving here today without asking these questions, as there is no guarantee that next week it will be taken. And as this goes on, it means that the Questions would be piled up, and the Speaker will direct that we should not even ask more than one supplementary question. That in itself defeats the purpose of asking questions. Asking questions is neither fun nor of aesthetic value. It is supposed to bring some relief to the recipients of the questions and the wider society.

So, Mr Speaker, these are the issues that I have. The others, because of your directive, I will leave them and I hope that God will help me, and I will have a more convenient time to ask these questions. But I cannot fight against the Leadership decision. We need to provide a conducive, friendly environment for the benefit of us all. The Leader of the House, who is very cool and calm, should allow us to ask questions, regardless of whether they are on the Business Statement, especially when they are relevant.

Mr Speaker, thank you for giving me this brief space.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Kingsley Nyarko, you know that if one Member asks three or four Questions and all these Questions are admitted, depending on the number of questioners, that is the number of Members who are to ask Questions, all your four Questions

may not be taken at a go, so that other Members are equally given an opportunity to also ask the Question.

Two, if all the Questions do not relate to the same subject matter, they group the Questions and programme the Ministers to provide answers to those Questions. So if two of your Questions go to Minister A and two go to Minister B, and it is Minister B who is scheduled to come and respond to the Questions, it will be totally impossible to schedule the other two Questions, whose Minister is not scheduled to come and respond to the question, to be answered. So, these are administrative issues that, as Members of Parliament, I feel we know.

If your question appears on the *Order Paper* and it has not been answered, or the *Order Paper* did not indicate the Question to be answered, all you need to do is make a gentle approach to the Table Office and resolve that particular issue with them. We admit the Questions for processing, and they are in charge of processing the Questions to be answered. Instead, you come to the Floor to raise the issue. I do not know how the Chamber will be able to address the issue, so I would advise that, in the circumstances, they are also human beings. It may be as a result of omission; you can draw their attention to it, and some of these things will be done in the background.

Yes, Hon Deputy Whip?

2:14 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader is smiling, and it is a beautiful Friday afternoon. So, when he is smiling, it means that he is ready to listen to what I want to say.

On Tuesday, 16th December, 2025, on the Business Committee's outline, there are a lot of Motions and Bills. The First Reading of the Appropriation Bill on page 2; the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill on page 3. Then there is the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) Bill, 2025. Hon Majority Leader, I do not know whether with all these Bills, it is your Committee's recommendation that we finish all these Bills. This is because on page 8, you said the House is adjourning *sine die* on the 19th December, 2024. Also, on Wednesday 17th December, 2025, we have tabled a number of Bills: The Bank of Ghana Bill, 2025 and the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the other thing is that Parliament is a house of records. The Majority Leader was on his feet, and he said that he is going to introduce a Private Member's Bill to repeal the Office of the Special Prosecutor (OSP). I have seen that he said the House is adjourning on Friday, but I cannot find that Bill in here. I want to find out from him whether he is abandoning it or not.

Also, I am aware that the Committee on Private Member's Bill and Private Member's Motion, ably chaired by Mr

Speaker, sat on this matter to the effect that the Committee wanted to see the legality of the repeal of the OSP Act. We know Mr Speaker's Committee will advise on the constitutionality of it and whether it is admissible or not.

I am aware that there is a request to the Majority Leader and the Majority Chief Whip to abandon the repeal the Office of the Special Prosecutor Act, 2017 (ACT 959). I want to find out from the Majority Leader whether he will still introduce the Bill to repeal the Act or not. He stated in here that he will be introducing it. So, if they will not introduce it again, based on the request of the President—Is it the case that the Majority Leader, excuse my French, does not have a mind of his own at the moment? He should let us know that he will not be introducing the Bill for the repeal of the OSP Act again. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, in the absence of any further comments—

Yes?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much. May I also thank the Chairman for the Business Committee, and I pray sincerely that the concern I have is admissible before you within the context of the Business Statement.

Mr Speaker, as we prepare to rise *sine die*, I wish to propose to the Committee, and for that matter, all the relevant stakeholders, that we consider a fumigation exercise during the recess time. The precinct of Parliament is heavily —

Mr Frist Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, look at the Business Statement before us, and tell me the aspect of the Business Statement that talks about fumigation?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, my understanding is that it is the Business Statement that will ferry concerns of this nature—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, please resume your seat.

Mr Addo-Kenneth — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know the practice. When we move from the Backbench to the Frontbench, I am not the type that will go to the Backbench. So, kindly resume your seats.

Hon Jerry, I will give you the benefit of the doubt.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I thank you very much. Mr Speaker has been very magnanimous today, and it feels like it is going to be a good day. I have just perused the Business Statement, and I want to commend the Majority Leader for bringing all of this to the fore. Mr Speaker, if you go to page 2, under Committee Reports on referrals, the Committee on Health deliberated largely on making provisions for about 10 of the Agenda 111 hospitals. They left out something which is very critical, which has to do with the Weija-Gbawe Paediatric Hospital. As we speak, Joy FM has reported today that there is termination of that contract and that it is

the only paediatric hospital here in Greater Accra, apart from the Princess Marie-Louise Hospital. The project is almost completed. As we speak, it has been reported that the contract has been terminated, and they are not going to proceed to finish that project. It is a World Bank project. As a man who loves children, I pray that you call on the Minister for Health—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib, I maintain here that if a procedure is set down for a right to be exercised, it is that procedure that will have to be followed in exercising the rights. The indication is that Committee on Health may submit a report for consideration of the House. Until and unless that report is submitted, how would the House be able to know whether what you are talking about was part of the deliberations and these are the recommendations coming from the Committee? So, I believe the issue that you are raising, for all intent and purposes, is premature.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I take a cue, save that Mr Speaker knows that some things can be belated, they can be late. It is a genuine and very honest submission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am not saying it is dishonest. I am not saying it is not genuine, but I am talking about the time and the period within which the issue is being raised. So, let us wait, for all of us will abide by the report of the Committee on Health.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, you seem to be talking about the Report before it is even laid. Very well, Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will call on the Leader of Government Business to respond to issues, and then we can have the Business Statement adopted.

Mr Ayariga: Thank you very much. I think the question about bringing Ministers and Independent Constitutional Bodies to brief the House has been adequately addressed by Mr Speaker, drawing attention to the relevant Standing Orders regarding how we get Ministers and leaders of Independent Constitutional Bodies to come to the House and answer Questions or brief us on urgent matters of concern.

I also think the question that Professor Nyarko asked about his Questions that have been listed are pertinent. Indeed, we have been advertising the Questions for quite a while now, but we have also been advertising the answers to the Questions. I think for a while now, the Hon Member also had the benefit of reading the answers to his Questions. We are only left with the Minister coming to read the answers, but the answers are equally advertised. You have your answers already, except that they have not been read to you by the Minister. In due course, the Minister will come and read the answers to the Hon Member. If you have follow-up Questions emanating from the answers, he can answer those ones as well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu asked a question about the Office of Special Prosecutor Repeal Bill. Indeed, it is true that we raised the issue in this Chamber. There were comments from both Sides of the

House and there appeared to be some consensus about dealing with the Office by way of reconsidering the existence of the Office. The Rt Hon Speaker then gave an indication that we know what to do as a House if we feel strongly about whether an institution should exist or cease to exist. Pursuant to that, I did submit a request to the Rt Hon Speaker to grant approval for a Private Member's Bill calling for the repeal of the Office to be considered by the Committee on Private Member's Bills and Private Members Motion. The Committee sat because when I submitted the Bill to the Speaker, co-signed by my Colleague, the Majority Chief Whip,

2:24 p.m.

The Speaker did refer the Bill to the Committee on Private Member's Bill and Private Member's Motion. The Committee sat on the Bill and gave approval for us to lay the Bill and I signed it. It is true also that yesterday, there was a statement, not a letter, a statement by H. E. President John Dramani Mahama requesting that I reconsider my decision.

Mr Speaker, we all know that two heads are better than one. *[Laughter]* So, if H. E. the President also has some thoughts on it and I add mine to his, I believe, together, we can find a better way of managing the situation. So, I can assure the House that I will take on board the request by H. E. the President for us to think about our action. I can assure the House that I have always had confidence in the wisdom of the President. Indeed, if I did not believe in his wisdom, I would

not have voted him to be President. So, on the basis of the request made to me by H. E. the President and my Colleague, the Majority Chief Whip, I want to assure the House that we will reconsider our decision. Thank you, Mr Speaker

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: I want to thank the Majority Leader for responding and also stating on record the events that surrounded, unfolded and led to this repeal of the Office of the Special Prosecutor (OSP). But what he has not been able to answer from my question is that he stated here that he will be introducing it. So, can he now state whether he will still introduce it or not? He should make it clear. After the request from the President, will he still introduce it or he will take it out?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib, I do not intend to give the floor to the Majority Leader. Our rules are clear as to the procedures to have a Private Member's Bill or Private Member's Motion introduced. From your own statement, they have done what they are supposed to do. It was referred to a Committee chaired by me, so the rest is internal procedure. It does not lie in the mouth of the sponsor of the Bill to determine whether he will introduce it or not.

If the Bill should fail any of the tests based on which a Private Member's Bill is supposed to be introduced in this House, it has its own implication. If the Bill passes the test, it also has its own implication. So far as we are concerned and what we have perused, the Bill is in the process and will be given a further consideration.

Hon Members, the Business Statement as presented is hereby adopted. Yes, Majority Leader? *[Pause]*

Hon Members, can we turn to the Commencement of Public Business and look at *Order Paper Addendum* and complete the exercise on the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I was trying to catch your eye so that before we take the Business on the *Order Paper Addendum*, we lay Papers slated under the item numbered 9 (a) and (b) quickly, then we go to the *Order Paper Addendum*. Mr Speaker, humbly requested.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: At the Commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers, the item numbered 9. The Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations.

Mr Dafeamekpor: The Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations was just here. So, Mr Speaker, may I pray that in his absence, the Minister for Roads and Highways do this on his behalf.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know why they always want to call the Minister for Roads and Highways. Because he was our Colleague in Leadership, it makes it very difficult for us to oppose. But where is the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations? He knows that he has Business in the Chamber and he has run away. Mr Speaker, we have

no objection; the Minister for Roads and Highways can do that.

Mr Ayariga: I sent the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations on an important errand. If Hon Habib has issues, I can ask him to come back.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, are you going to answer this question? Should the Minister come back?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Roads and Highways can do that.

PAPERS

By the Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) on behalf of the Minister for Communication, Technology and Innovations —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Meteorological Agency for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Information and Communications.

By the Chairperson of the Committee —

Report of the Finance Committee on the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we now turn to *Order Paper Addendum* and take the item numbered 1, Motion. That is, the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025, that it should be read the Third time.

Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem: Mr Speaker, I seek your leave to do that on behalf of my Minister.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Leave is hereby granted.

BILL — THIRD READING

Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP) *on behalf of the Minister for Finance:* Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025 be now read the Third time.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong) *on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee:* Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

The Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025 – *read the Third time and passed.*

2:34 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let me pray you that we take the item on *Order Paper Addendum* 2, so that we can lay the Report from the House Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have any difficulties.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

PAPER

By the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the House Committee on an orientation workshop on the status of facilities and services available to Members of Parliament for the smooth discharge of their mandates.

Hon Members, the Report has been duly presented, and it is for distribution to Hon Members of the House.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Deputy Minority Leader has a short but very important Statement. I want to pray you to go back to item numbered 8 on the *Order Paper*, Statements, so that we can take that quickly, then we can return to Government Business.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, it appears I do not have the Statement by the— Did you say the Statement is standing in the name of Deputy Minority or Majority Leader?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Deputy Minority Leader.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. In effect, two Statements: one is a Statement by Hon Dzifa Abla Gomashie, the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, on the inscription of Highlife Music and the other one was in the name of Hon Patricia Appiagyie, on upholding the rule of law and due process in Ghana's democratic system. So, they say ladies first, and both makers of the Statement are ladies. So, I will give the preference to my right, Hon Dzifa Abla Gomashie, to make her Statement, after which I will give the floor to the Deputy Minority Leader.

Hon Minister, you have the floor.

STATEMENTS

Inscription of Highlife Music

Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts (Ms Dzifa Abla Gomashie) (MP): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. It is with profound honour that I announce to this august House the inscription of Highlife as an intangible cultural heritage of humanity originating from Ghana.

I wish to begin by acknowledging the United Nations Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) for its continued dedication to safeguarding the cultural expressions that define and enrich societies. Ghana is especially grateful for this recognition of Highlife music and dance by UNESCO. This acknowledgement not only affirms our history but also strengthens our cultural identity and our place within the global creative landscape.

Mr Speaker, Highlife music and dance emerged in the early 20th century in the coastal regions of Ghana, evolving from indigenous rhythms, storytelling traditions, and the musical influences that accompanied our own sociocultural transformations. It blended local melodies with brass band elements, guitar rhythms, and later urban band styles. Highlife became the soundtrack of Ghana's independence movement, a symbol of national pride and a cultural bridge connecting generations.

Mr Speaker, over the decades, Highlife has inspired numerous other African and global musical genres, shaped the continent's musical identity, and contributed to Ghana's international cultural footprint. Highlife music and dance are not merely artistic expressions, but they are sources of livelihood and engines of socioeconomic development.

Across generations, Highlife has: created employment for musicians, dancers, sound engineers, instrument makers, event organisers, fashion designers, lawyers, accountants, cultural educators, *et cetera*; supported thousands more directly through hospitality, tourism, nightlife industries, media productions, and cultural events; inspired festivals, concerts and cultural tourism, activities that stimulate local economies in cities and communities across Ghana.; and attracted global attention by drawing researchers, cultural tourists and music enthusiasts to contribute to Ghana's creative economy.

Mr Speaker, Highlife, simply put, continues to feed families, build careers,

and sustain communities. The Ministry of Tourism, Culture, and Creative Arts and its implementing agencies remain steadfast in their commitment to promoting, preserving, and advancing our cultural heritage. The recognition of High Life by UNESCO strengthens our resolve to do even more. The Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, in collaboration with sister Ministries, will continue to develop policies and programmes aimed at strengthening documentation, research, and archiving traditional knowledge. We will support practitioners and traditional communities who keep our heritage alive. Mr Speaker, the Ministry is also working hard to establish frameworks to protect intellectual property and the rights of cultural practitioners.

Mr Speaker, finally, we are making preparations to nominate additional Ghanaian cultural expressions for UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage List, ensuring that more of our traditions, festivals, crafts, and performing arts receive global recognition. These efforts form part of Ghana's broader strategy to elevate the creative economy, empower communities, and position culture as a driver of sustainable development.

2:44 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I wish to humbly remind Ghanaians that intangible cultural heritage is a living force and it is what holds the key to unlocking the potentials that we have. It shapes who we are today and guides who we can become tomorrow.

I cannot conclude, Mr Speaker, without thanking the President, H. E. John Dramani Mahama, under whose leadership Ghana has achieved this historic success; to thank the Vice-President, H. E. Prof Jane Naana Opoku Agyemang, who loves to dance to highlife music like my good self, the Chief of Staff, Mr Julius Debrah, my very able Deputy Minister, Hon Yussif Issaka Jajah, Directors and Staff of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, and all its agencies, especially, the Folklore Board led by Mr Felix Adjavon.

Mr Speaker, with your kind leave, may I request that you permit me to ask this august House to observe a moment of silence in remembrance of the late Dr Owusu, Nana Ampadu, Charles Kojo Fosu (Daddy Lumba), Naa Amanua Doodoo, among others, who have played their part and passed on, but indeed we remember them for contributing immensely to this feat that we have achieved. May our collective efforts continue to celebrate and respect diversity, strengthen unity, and secure a proud future for the generations that follow.

Mr Speaker, if I have your permission that we stand for and observe a moment's silence, I would appreciate it. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I am inclined to grant the request, however, let us finish the Statement, take the comment, and then we can observe the minute's silence.

Ms Gomashie: I am grateful, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that is a Statement on the Floor. We will now take comments.

Yes, Hon Darko-Mensah?

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Thank you very much for this opportunity.

Mr Speaker, like she said, highlife actually emerged from the coastal areas, and everybody knows that one area that was very solid for highlife music was the Western Region. In fact, you can talk about the likes of C. K. Mann, Papa Yankson, Paa Thomas, Felix Owusu, and the current reigning Highlife champion, Kofi Kanata. So, for me, we are happy that UNESCO has recognised highlife as a Ghanaian original artwork, and I believe that it is time as a country that we started looking at new ways of monetising highlife properly. If you take the lives of many of the older generation, even though artistically they were brilliant, economically they did not have the economic well-being in their olden ages.

Mr Speaker, highlife is timeless. In fact, if we consider how highlife has been able to support other genres, you would see that highlife is really timeless. As a music student at Mfantsipim School, I know that if you want to recognise a song as highlife, it is that little beat that goes like *ka-ka-ka-ka-ka-ka* in the music. In fact, Afrobeat, which is a faster version of highlife, also came

from highlife, and usually Afrobeat will go like *ka-ka-ka-ka-ka-ka-ka*, and that is Afrobeat. As we speak, we know that hip-life is also a modification of the highlife genre. We can see that there is that connection that connects the dots, that if we get the highlife solid, the other genres can also develop and be monetised for the good of society.

Mr Speaker, I am a big fan of C. K. Mann's, *Adwoa Yankie*, you see that song, you get that song, yes. So, I believe that it is time that we support the highlife, because currently, only a few artists are actually engaged in highlife, and if we are not careful, it might die off. So, I believe that we need to have a strategic arrangement to make sure that we can easily or quickly pick those who are showing promise in that area, support them to grow, and make sure that they can deliver more for this country.

Mr Speaker, I have been associated with music for a long time. My grandmother actually set up the first nightclub in Takoradi. In her days, highlife was the key songs that were being played before the foreign music came, and then now we are getting a better, effective promotion of hip-life also joining in. So, I believe that this is a good progress we have made as a country, but like we all know, most musicians in Ghana always complain that they are not getting real value for their labour, and I am talking about intellectual property. Every time Ghana Music Right Organisation (GHAMRO) and the rest come up, they seem always to be accused of not organising the monetary aspects for artists in this

country, and I believe that the Ministry might have to quickly look at that particular area to make sure that the investment our artists put in these works, especially in old age, accrue some benefits that can sustain them, so that younger generations can also learn from them and also start contributing artistically to this country. In America, music is money, and we should be able to make it work here in Ghana.

With these few years, Mr Speaker, I thank you for this opportunity to contribute to the effort by the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts efforts in promoting highlife music. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, on this note, let us observe a minute's silence.

[A minutes' silence was observed]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will now give the floor to Hon Patricia Appiagyei, and I would open comment on this subject to some limitations.

Upholding the Rule of Law and Due Process in Ghana's Democratic System

Deputy Minority Leader (Ms Patricia Appiagyei): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity, and I stand on Order 93(1) to make this Statement on a matter of urgent public concern.

Mr Speaker, the standard law and procedure in the courts and in the parts of Parliament of Ghana is that when a matter or a process is the subject matter of a suit pending before a court of competent jurisdiction, no one should do anything or take any step whatsoever until all the processes a party is entitled to have been exhausted. In short, the *status quo ante* should be maintained at all costs.

Mr Speaker, every suit has a subject matter. If at any stage one party decides to destroy the subject matter of the suit while the suit is still pending before a court, so as to render a possible decision of the court nugatory, the offender is guilty of contempt and will be punished by the law. A party for whom a judgement has been given in a land case cannot enter the land and pull down the building thereon while an appeal has been filed and a motion for the stay of execution is pending before any court with jurisdiction over any aspect of the case.

2:54 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in fact, the law and its practice herein affects any due process whatsoever, including what is known as prerogative writs, certiorari, mandamus, prohibition, and quo warranto. If a party is of the view that a judge has made a decision which exceeds his powers, is illegal, or has given a party a cow while the party brought a suit demanding a goat, the defendant may file a prerogative writ to quash the judgement and also file an appeal and an application for stay of execution.

No court in the civilised world will allow the party for whom judgement has been given for the cow to slaughter it while there is any process touching and concerning the matter before the court.

Mr Speaker, it is a fundamental principle of law that, all things being equal, the position in which the parties were before a civil suit began should be kept during the pendency of the suit. If the contrary is done, the law of the jungle will reign, and justice will be abused.

Mr Speaker, let us ask ourselves in the case before us, that if the Court of Appeal should give a judgement that nothing improper happened during the election and that the election's result must stand or that a re-run must be done in only the few polling stations which the plaintiff himself made the subject matter of the suit, saying those were the places the irregularities had occurred, what should we do?

In the meantime, the Electoral Commission, in indecent and unlawful haste, would have conducted an election and the person who has lost the case according to the law, has now been sworn in as a Member of Parliament (MP), Ghana would become a lawless jungle.

Mr Speaker, this is what happened in the cases of Hon Cynthia Mamle Morrison, Hon Dan Abodakpi, the late Hon Sakande, Hon James Gyakyere Quayson, as well as other cases. Each MP remained in Parliament till the cases were fully finished in court.

Mr Speaker, what is playing out now has never happened in this Fourth Republic and we are throwing the rule of law to the dogs. Illegality and populist brutality, typical of PNDC days, should not be countenanced.

Mr Speaker, it is for this reason that we in the Minority were pleasantly surprised, when the Rt Hon Speaker Bagbin could supervise the release of the letter by the Clerk to Parliament—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I think you have ended the Statement that is before me. What you are adding is not part of the Statement that was brought before me to be admitted.

Ms Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, what I am adding is that, I would like us, as a House and a country, to ensure that upholding the rule of law and process—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the Rule does not demand that when your Statement is admitted, you go beyond what has been admitted.

Thank you very much.

Hon Members, not seeing anybody on his feet, that brings us to the end of the Statement time.

Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I want to crave your indulgence so that we go back to the main *Order Paper*; the page numbered 19 and the item numbered 34.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the item numbered 34.

BILL — SECOND READING

Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP) *on behalf of the Minister for Finance:* Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong) *on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee:* Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to present your Committee's Report.

Mr Speaker, I call on *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as having been read.

Introduction

The Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (NO. 2) Bill, 2025 was presented to Parliament by Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Ampem Nyarko on behalf of the Minister for Finance, in accordance with

Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and read for the first time on Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025.

Subsequently, the Bill was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 226 of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Bill, met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Ampem Nyarko and officials from the Ministry of Finance, Bank of Ghana and the legislative drafting division of the Attorney-General's Department.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents in the consideration of the Bill:

- i. The 1992 Constitution
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii. The Petroleum Management Act, 2011 (Act 815) as amended
- iv. The Petroleum Management Regulations, 2019
- v. The 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government

Object of the Bill

The object of the Bill is to amend the Petroleum Revenue Management Act,

2011 (Act 815) to expand the definition of “qualifying investment” to include other qualifying instruments prescribed by the Minister by Executive Instrument.

Content of the Bill

The Bill contains a clause which seeks to amend the definition of “qualifying instruments” as proposed in Section 61 of Act 815 to include “any other qualifying instruments that the Minister may prescribe by Executive Instrument.”

Observation

Rationale for the Bill

The Committee observed that Section 27 of Act 815 provided for the Investment rules to be applied when investing the petroleum funds. The section also designated a range of instruments as qualifying instruments and provided that the instruments were to be reviewed every three years or sooner by the Minister on the advice of the Investment Advisory Council (IAC).

Section 61 of Act 815 defined a qualifying instrument as a debt instrument denominated in internationally convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest, an internationally convertible currency deposit with or debt instrument denominated in any internationally convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest, or a derivative instrument that is solely based on an instrument that satisfies the above indicated requirements.

The Ministry informed the Committee that Parliament has approved the International Advisory Council’s advice to include new qualifying instruments for investment of Ghana Petroleum Funds. However, the definition of qualifying instrument under section 61 of Act 815 did not allow for any other qualifying instruments to be added to the existing instruments. There is the need to amend Section 61 of Act 815 to expand the range of qualifying instruments to be used for investing the GPF. The Minister indicated that the Bill will enable the Minister to add any new qualifying instruments through the issuance of an Executive Instrument.

Expected Increase in Investment Returns

The Committee also observed that for the past fifteen years, only 1 per cent has been earned from the investment of the petroleum funds. Amending Act 815 will provide more options for investing into other high yielding portfolios. It is expected that the new instruments will enable the state to earn more than 10 per cent annually on the investments. The Minister assured the Committee that the new investments would adhere to all existing safeguards prescribed by the Act.

Recommendation

Proposed Amendments

After careful consideration, the Committee makes the following proposed amendments:

Clause 1 – Amendment Proposed – paragraph (a), subparagraph (ii), line 4, after “rating;” *insert* “or”.

(Chairman of the Committee)

Clause 1 – Amendment proposed – paragraph (b), subparagraph (ii), after “Bank;” *delete* “or” and in subparagraph (iii), line 3, after “ranting;” *insert* “or”.

(Chairman of the Committee)

Conclusion

After deliberations with the relevant stakeholders, the Committee is of the view that the Amendment Bill is a step in the right direction to provide for the investment of the resources of the Ghana Petroleum Funds into any other qualifying instruments that the Minister may prescribe by Executive Instrument for the benefit of the Country.

The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt the Report and approve the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. Respectfully, I do not think we have the numbers to continuously conduct the Business of this House. With your leave, I therefore come under Order 64(1) and ask that Members be called in for us to

count the number of Members here, or else, we are raising the issue of Quorum that we do not have the numbers to proceed to do Business.

Mr Speaker, that is my submission, that we do not have the numbers to proceed to conduct Business. So, I am raising the issue of Quorum per Order 64 (3).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader, Order 64 has been invoked.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I am sure the appropriate presumptions will apply until the processes— *[Interruption]*

3:04 p.m.

It was raised 10 minutes ago. I have been around and I did not hear the bell ring. I thought that at Conclave, we had a gentleman understanding. At Conclave, we had an understanding that we will do these things today. Hon Habib Iddrisu was there and we agreed that we would take this matter. These are very simple, non-contentious— He was there and we agreed to do these things. We would vary the Order of Business, make the Statement again and comment —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, Hon Members, the truth be told, at the conclusion of the Statement, I will look up to see whether a Member is on his or her feet to comment on the Statement. I saw Hon Prof Kingsley Nyarko, who all of a sudden resumed his seat again.

Hon Members, at the point where I indicated Statement time had ended, there was nobody on their feet to

comment on the Statement. I do not know what the delay was. I guess that we were expecting comments from my right when the Statement was made by a Member from my left and there was nobody on their feet either from my right. I have not seen anybody from my right on their feet.

Hon Members, my attention has been drawn to Quorum, particularly, Order 64. Order 64(4) is clear as to the procedure. I therefore direct the Clerks-at-the-Table to cause the bell to be rung for the required minute and it is then that we can proceed to take decisions. So, Clerks-at-the-Table, may you ring the bell. In the meantime, we would proceed to debate the second reading.

Yes, Hon Dr Tiah Abdul Kabiru Mahama?

Dr Tiah Abdul Kabiru Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Mr Speaker, the Finance Committee of Parliament met to examine the referral, the proposed amendment to the Petroleum Revenue Management Act.

Mr Speaker, the only thing that the Ministry is asking from the Committee and from the House is to introduce a new provision that seeks to become like an omnibus provision, allowing the Minister for Finance to come by way of Executive Instruments that diversifies the investment to which our petroleum revenue could be used to give Ghana the highest return possible for the resources that we sow. It is important to note that money that sits in one's account is effectively no money because with time,

the value of that money diminishes. If we are accumulating revenue from the proceeds of our resources and that money is just idling in our accounts, it does not give the good people of Ghana any value. For that reason, the decision to invest the revenue by way of putting it into some qualified instruments was very well placed and was a good decision taken by this House in the past.

Mr Speaker, admittedly, from the Report from the Ministry of Finance, our returns are only some — just to keep the value of the money. It does not give us any returns that we expect. So, the principle of this particular amendment is very well and good. However, the difficulty we have was to the fact that this provision is so open and it gives the Ministry the opportunity to invest in anything that it deems fit or based on the advice from the advisory board.

Mr Speaker, the resources that they are investing are the resources of the people of Ghana and there are resources that we are supposed to have oversight of. After the board advises them and they do some bad investment, what happens to the resources of the people of Ghana? It was for that reason that we argued strenuously and we prevailed on the Minister to let it be subject to prior Parliamentary approval because once those stated in the law are clear and the Minister can go on and invest, the omnibus provision lacks clarity as to what they can invest in. They are just saying that any other qualifying instrument that, based on the advice of the advisory board, the Fund can decide to put the money or the revenue or even

to invest the revenue into. But that is the problem and I am at difficulty to go to sleep, even though I do not have issues as to whether or not the Deputy Minister for Finance, Hon Thomas Nyarko Ampem and his boss, the Minister for Finance would do the right thing. Imagine, even if we give them the benefit of the doubt, and let us assume that His Excellency President John Mahama should do a reshuffle and a different Minister for Finance is sitting on the table, what is the guarantee that that Minister's judgement and the judgement of that advisory committee is going to be in the benefit of the people of Ghana? It is for that reason that we were of the view that the proposed amendment should rather be made clear.

Mr Speaker, the qualifying instrument that the Minister thinks that they want to put there— Because they cannot say that they are not getting revenue, and they know what to use the money for to give them revenue, and they do not want to tell us what they want to use the money for. Basically, that is the difficulty the Committee is facing, and that is the difficulty this House will be facing. This is because as of now, the Minister has not told us what other qualifying instrument they have in contemplation.

Mr Speaker, I think that when one has other qualifying instrument in contemplation, they must let the House know, and must put it into the Bill. Or if they want the lean way, because of the fluidity of investment, because there are emerging market opportunities or there are emerging opportunities for us to invest into, then we must also subject it

to prior Parliamentary approval, so that when we realise that a matter is of importance and that it is going to give revenue to the country, and that when we put our money there, we are going to get expected returns, then it should be subjected to prior Parliamentary approval. Otherwise, we are giving the Ministry a blank cheque and I do not want us to give the Ministry a blank cheque.

Mr Speaker, I do not think that giving the Ministry a blank cheque would help. I think that we must put factors as to what the Ministry can do with our money. Mr Speaker, I am at great difficulty on that. In principle, investment of our resources is good, but the omnibus and the two blank cheques that would be offered to the Ministry of Finance, or Mr Cassiel Ato Forson is not good for our resources management. I do not think that this House should give that blank cheque.

Mr Speaker, the principle is good, but the offer of blank cheque is deadly for resource governance.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, does the existing law allow the Minister to do so? Or is it this Amendment Bill that is giving —

Dr T. A. K. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the Memorandum following this Bill is clear on what the Ministry seeks to do. Under section 61 of this Act, I read;

“Qualifying Instruments applies to debt instruments denominated in

international convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest. An international convertible currency deposit, which or debt instrument denominated in any internationally convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest.”

3:14 p.m.

“Qualifying instruments applies to debt instruments denominated in international convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest. An international convertible currency deposit, which or debt instrument denominated in any internationally convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest.”

Mr Speaker, “Qualifying instruments” are defined by the law, and it was for good reason that in the parent Act, we define what qualifies for us to put our money into. When you read the last paragraph of the Act, they propose to amend this particular section 61, to provide for the investment of resources of the Ghana Petroleum to other Qualifying instruments.

So, Mr Speaker, the blank cheque is the “other Qualifying instruments”. Because the makers of this law did not want to give the Hon Minister of Finance a blank cheque, that was why they defined what “Qualifying instruments” are, and we now want to make nonsense of that particular definition that we provided in the Act, to say “other”. It is

an omnibus provision, and if the Hon Minister has in contemplation certain Qualifying instruments which they think our money can get us higher returns, they should let us include that, rather than just say “other Qualifying instruments”, and that the Hon Minister may come by way of Executive Instrument to invest our money into “other Qualifying instruments”; that is the argument we are making.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this should not be taken to say that I am taking part in the debate. In the parent Act, Section 27(1), it gives the power for the “Qualifying instruments” to be done by the Hon Minister using an Executive Instrument, and the Executive Instrument will specify what exactly the Hon Minister would have to do.

In one breath, we limit the Hon Minister, and in another breath, we are giving the opportunity to the Hon Minister to do so by an Executive Instrument. It therefore means that if there is a Qualifying instrument better than whatever is spelt out, though the power is given to the Hon Minister to do so by an Executive Instrument, they cannot do it, and it is not limited to only the current Minister; it will apply to subsequent Ministers. So, the necessity is to provide an omnibus clause to give the opportunity to the Minister to explore; that is my understanding of this particular Bill. So, the Bill only seeks to improve the definition of “Qualifying instruments”.

Well, I will open the floor.

Mr Ayariga — rose —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I saw Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah, so, Hon Majority Leader, in the absence of anybody from your back, let me take him, and then I will come to you, and then we will conclude on the issue.

Mr Darko-Mensah: Mr Speaker, under normal circumstances, this should not be a major debate because everybody agrees that what we are accruing from the wealth funds is not enough, and that is the data that has been brought to us. So, everybody is looking at how we can increase that as quickly as possible. But as we all know, there should be safeguards in whichever alternative Qualifying instruments we are looking at, because giving a blank cheque to the Hon Minister might also be dangerous. The Executive Instrument is just an announcement, and like the principle that the Hon Majority Leader espoused this morning, that two heads are better than one, I believe that it makes the whole country safer if they bring it to Parliament to have some conclusion on the new Qualifying instruments they might be introducing in the Executive Instrument. The Executive Instrument is just an announcement. If you take even the way we process the Legislative Instrument (L.I.) in this House, by Constitution and by our new arrangement, it is only consultation that is done with Parliament, and then the changes are made, and the final one is brought into the House.

So, I believe that even though we want the Ministry to take bigger risks, there have to be calculated risks. I believe that in the current circumstance

that we find ourselves, I strongly support the position of Dr Kabiru Mahama that we might have to change it such that it is not just qualifying and opening a blank cheque for the Hon Minister to do whatever he wants to do, but at least bring it here, so that when we all support him and he sends it out there, he has the backing of the House —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, are you proposing it should be by a Legislative Instrument?

Mr Darko-Mensah: Mr Speaker, the amendment should include a session that would say that it should be presented to Parliament for prior approval, because usually, they would do a lot of research before they take a decision, and then they go and invest. We can skew it so that maybe the Committee on Finance or the Committee on Economy and Development can meet—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In that case, we are going beyond the proposed amendment before us to seek an amendment of the parent Act, which is not proposed to be amended here. Clearly, section 27 is not to be amended, and section 27 says it must be done by an Executive Instrument. So, what this amendment seeks to do is to expand the scope of the Qualifying instrument; apart from that, this Bill is doing nothing. So, the principle underpinning the expansion is what we are supposed to debate at Second Reading.

Do you have a copy of the Bill?

Mr Darko-Mensah: Yes, I have gotten it.

Mr Speaker, I believe that the Bill is very clear, but in view of the fact that we have all agreed in the discussions we had the last time, that we need to expand it for them to invest in more risky opportunities, even though they are qualifying the instrument, this new phenomenon needs to be taken care of and looked at. Since we are here, we should find a way to get it reflected in this amendment, and that should be possible.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr John Darko.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, I had the opportunity to look at this amendment, and even before that, I realised that the Hon Minister for Finance, before the Budget reading, presented a memorandum which this House adopted, and that memorandum sought to do the same thing by asking for expansion of the definition of Qualifying instruments to enable the Minister for Finance more or less have more access to petroleum funds than Act 815 allows.

Mr Speaker, I largely disagree with my Colleagues that even this amendment is all right. When the Makers of the Bill in 2011 passed the Bill, they had something in mind, and that was to protect the funds for future generations. They did so to make the Qualifying instruments so restrictive, so that no Hon Minister, at his whims and caprices, would be able to invest our monies into riskier investments. I am worried that we are trying to take that away from the future generation. If we allow this amendment to pass, what is going to

happen is that now, the next Hon Minister for Finance would have a blank cheque. They would be able to touch our petroleum funds. What section 27 talks about, on the Ghana Petroleum Fund, may be useless at some point, because when the oil is finally depleted, due to risky investment, we may not have anything to call the Petroleum Wealth Fund, which is supposed to be used for future generations.

3:24 p.m.

So, Mr Speaker, even though arguments have been made that we are not making enough money from the investment in its current situation, I disagree. If we look at the 2024/2025 Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) report, it clearly shows that we have made much more money. I do not have my reports here, but I had wanted to quote from the 2025 PIAC report. But, Mr Speaker, if we look at the Budget and the 2025 PIAC report, there is a clear difference in terms of the monies we have realised from the investment.

Unfortunately, and I want to believe this was an oversight, the Budget understates the amount of money we have made from the investment as compared to the PIAC report. And I remember during the debates on the Budget, I made this point that we are trying to change this, and for that matter, we want the people of Ghana to believe that we are not making enough money from the investment. So let us change it so that we can make more money. This will be very risky. I believe that if we

maintain the status quo, it will help us and even future generations.

Mr Speaker, this is my contribution to this. I completely disagree that the qualifying instruments should be expanded. I believe that the status quo should remain just for the purposes of future generations.

Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Mahama Ayariga, Majority Leader.

Mr Mahama Ayariga (NDC — Bawku Central): Thank you very much.

I think we need to look fundamentally at how investment is done. How is investment done? Investment is not made at the whims and caprices of the Minister. Not at all. The Act establishes an investment advisory committee, and that committee has a statutory obligation to advise the Minister on how to invest. At that stage, Parliament is involved. Parliament is involved because Section 39 says that “the Minister shall provide Parliament with any advice given by the investment advisory committee within seven days”. So, to all intents and purposes, it is practically impossible for a Minister to actually take investment decisions without Parliament becoming aware.

Section 39(2) says that “the Minister shall, within seven days after the re-examination of the decision made under Section 38(5), inform Parliament of the decision”. So, when he re-examines any decision regarding investment, he must

again inform Parliament within seven days. Therefore, the concerns about the role of Parliament in monitoring and keeping an eagle eye on the investment made are taken care of by the requirement of the law for the Minister to inform Parliament within seven days of receiving any advice on how to invest.

Now, let us go to the Hon Member’s concerns. His concerns relate to the definition of a qualifying instrument and giving the Minister greater room in defining qualifying instruments. But again, if we pay attention to Section 27, it says:

“The resources of the Ghana Petroleum Fund and subsequently the Ghana Petroleum Wealth Fund shall be invested in qualifying instruments prescribed by Executive Instrument.”

So already, the legislation says that the Executive Instrument should prescribe the qualifying instrument, but that is not even where my focus is. My focus is on Section 27(2), which says that

“the range of instruments designated as qualifying instruments shall be reviewed every three years or sooner by the Minister on the advice of the Investment Advisory Committee.”

It means that the law contemplates that the range could expand as the financial sector continues to innovate and introduce new instruments that fall within the definition of a qualifying instrument. So, the law did not intend to

freeze the definition of a qualifying instrument. Although it proceeds to an interpretation section and attempts to define the qualifying instrument by setting characteristics, it is all aimed at ensuring that it is safe.

It then admits in 27(2) that what it says cannot be definitive of available qualifying instruments and that there could be a range. So, as the financial sector innovates and bring on board new instruments, the Minister every three years or even before the end of every three years should continue also to revise his Executive Instrument in order to bring in other qualifying instruments which may not be defined in this Act as a qualifying instrument because new varieties will emerge, and we cannot, at every time, come back to this House to say we are amending the definition of qualifying instruments. It is to further this and make it easier. I even think that perhaps there is no need. Are we getting the point? There is no need.

All the Minister needs to do is to say this is a new qualifying instrument and come and report to Parliament because, within seven days, he must inform Parliament anyway. But then he felt that there was a need to accommodate that in some more expansive definition of a qualifying instrument in the Interpretation clause. I had extensive discussions with him about this and said that if we looked at 27 (1) and (2), it says there could be a range, and new ones would come. Within three years, if he deems it necessary to amend his Executive Instrument or introduce new ones, his only obligation is to always inform Parliament.

If Hon Members would recall, we had a similar problem with issuing bonds when we started because the requirement of prior approval of Parliament came up, and that was how we realised that the way the financial market works. We cannot go there and enter into a bond agreement and then come back to Parliament to say that we are going to get approval of Parliament. By the time we get back to the market, the dynamics would have changed. We then innovated and said we would give approval if it is within a certain range, and they should go ahead and commit. Is that not what we did?

So, it is a situation where new qualifying instruments are emerging in the market that are equally safe, with the characteristics outlined in 61(1) (a), (b), and (c). These characteristics are intended to ensure that it is secure, but it is not exhaustive. The idea is to include additional (d) so that any qualifying instrument the Minister may prescribe by Executive Instrument will further reassure the Minister when he decides to proceed with certain qualifying instruments. I will urge Colleagues to focus on the reporting obligations of the Minister, who will always be aware of what he is investing in and

3:34 p.m.

If he comes and informs this Parliament that I have been advised by the Investment Advisory Committee to invest in 1, 2, 3, 4, 5. When one makes an Executive Instrument defining new qualifying instruments, it is not a decision to invest in those qualifying

instruments. One has only expanded the range of qualifying instruments. It is the Advisory Committee that will advise on whether even what we have expanded our Executive Instrument to include should be accepted. The Minister has issued an Executive Instrument saying 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, qualify as qualified instruments. That is not an investment, because he does not take the investment decisions. It is the Advisory Committee that will look at all that, including the new ones that he has added, and come to a conclusion that what he has added is equally safe, and therefore we should invest in it. But whatever the case, when he issues an Executive Instrument, it becomes a public document. Those of us who are monitoring the work of the Ministry will see it. When the Advisory Committee decides that that new category of qualifying instrument should be invested in by the Government of Ghana, that is something that the Minister must come and report to us that his Advisory Committee has accepted that he should invest in this. We have the opportunity at that stage to say no or yes, because we think that there is a problem. I do not think that there is any real danger, and so I urge Colleagues that we should allow this to go and we should vote and approve the Motion that the Bill be now read a Second time.

Mr Speaker, I so submit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will give the opportunity to the Deputy Minister to conclude.

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader has made a lot of points, and he has made

them clearly. I just want to reiterate that, section 27 (2) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act (Act 815) states clearly that:

“(2) The range of instruments designated as qualifying instruments shall be reviewed every three years or sooner by the Minister on the advice of the Investment Advisory Committee”

Ironically, since 2014, no Minister for Finance has reviewed the qualifying instruments as stipulated in the Act. Dr Ato Forson intends to implement the law as it is stated. Mr Speaker, if we go to section 61 of the Act, it gives the meaning of qualifying instruments. It defines qualifying instruments to mean, (a) a debt instrument denominated in internationally convertible currency, and the rest continues, (b) an internationally convertible currency, and (c) a derivative instrument. So, any other qualifying instrument that is outside these three are not defined in this law. So, this law will not recognise any other qualifying instrument outside these three, because it states clearly that qualifying instruments means A, B, and C.

This same law states in Section 27 that a Minister for Finance must review the qualifying instrument every three years or sooner through an E.I., subject to 61. But if it is reviewed, and whatever new ones are introduced is not defined, here, how will it be implemented? Under section 39, it puts obligation on the Minister for Finance that any time he receives advice from the Investment

Advisory Committee, he must, within seven days, report to Parliament. The Minister for Finance received the advice and rushes to Parliament to present the details of the advice he received from the Investment Advisory Committee. I just want to quote a portion of it.

Mr Speaker, some of the Members, in fact, many of the Members who spoke agree that we are not earning enough from the investment so far. In paragraph 6, the Committee says,

“Our assessment of the performance of the Ghana Petroleum Funds shows that the returns on the funds have been sub-optimal due to the narrow range of the Qualifying Instruments provided for under section 61 of Act 815. For example, since their inception in 2011 up to December 2024, the Ghana Petroleum Funds have successfully accumulated reserves (closing book value) of US\$1.456 billion, demonstrating a significant effort made to build up the nation's oil wealth for savings and investments. Nevertheless, the Ghana Petroleum Funds have generated a net profit (investment income) of US\$194.89 million during these years, representing 13.39 per cent over the period or an average annual return of approximately 1 per cent. Comparatively, the benchmark S&P 500 Index has delivered an average annualised return of approximately 14 per cent over the same period? Similarly, investing in an electricity power plant in West Africa typically yields risk-adjusted international rates of return ranging from 8 per cent to 12 per cent in USD.”

So, it is not in dispute that we are not earning enough. It is therefore important that we expand this. One Hon Member was saying we have not come to this House to tell the House what the Minister intends to invest the funds in. That is not the case. When the Minister reported to this House, he also stated the advice in details, the recommended addition to the qualifying instruments that the Investment Advisory Committee has given. That was stated clearly. But for time, I would have listed them for Members to see. Briefly, they gave this advice, and one of them is foreign currency denominated debt instruments issued under government-approved frameworks to finance national energy investments in the following areas and the B is Sovereign and Multilateral Energy Instruments which are denominated in internationally convertible currencies and hold investment-grade or equivalent rating — All these details were presented to this House. We are not looking for a blank cheque, as the Hon Member suggested. The Minister for Finance wants to follow due process; he wants to follow the law.

Mr Speaker, I want to appeal to all of us. All we are asking for is one-line insertion to add in any other qualifying instruments that the Minister may prescribe by Executive Instrument to allow the Minister to issue an Executive Instrument and list those additional qualifying instruments that the Investment Advisory Committee has given to him.

I so submit, Mr Speaker. Thank you.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 accordingly read a Second time.

Mr First Deputy Minister: Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Yes, Mr Speaker, item numbered 35, Consideration Stage.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Petroleum Management (Amendment) (No.2) Bill at Consideration Stage.

3.44 p.m.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025

Clause 1 – Section 61 of Act 815 amended.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Clause 1 - amendment proposed — paragraph (a), subparagraph (ii), line 4, after “rating;” insert “or”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, clause 1 - amendment proposed — paragraph (b), subparagraph (ii), line 3, after “rating;” insert “or”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this appears to be consequential. It is for your consideration.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, at the interpretation section, we are introducing a new (d). So, (d) will read, “Any other qualified instrument that the Minister may prescribe by Executive Instrument.”. I so submit.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 1 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will further direct the draftsman to take note of the use of the disjunctive “or” rather than the conjunctive “and”.

Long Title ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That brings us to the end of the Consideration Stage of the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Motion numbered 36, Minister for Finance?

BILL — THIRD READING

Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) *on behalf of*

the Minister for Finance: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to *move*:

That the Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 be now read the Third time.

Vice-Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

The Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 – *read the Third time and passed.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, can we go back to the item numbered 33?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, did you say the item numbered 33 or 32? What Motion did you mention?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, it is the Motion numbered 31.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025 be read a Second time. Minister for Health?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Yes, Mr Speaker, I want to seek your permission for the Deputy Minister for Finance to do that as the Minister is not here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, my very good Friend and classmate.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, as you can see, Hon Dafeamekpor— My Colleagues on that Committee are saying that they have never sighted the Bill. Mr Speaker, respectfully—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Jerry Ahmed, the *Order Papers* will bear me out that this is a Bill that has been on the Order Paper for Second reading for several weeks. This clearly is National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025. Is it not the Committee on Health?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, you also would agree with me that there is a possibility that it finds itself on the *Order Paper*, but it may not have gone to the Committee. It is good for us to be prudent on this matter. At least, I know that Hon Kabiru will not lie about it; he is ever present. I am not saying anybody is lying. But I am telling them that this is what Hon Kabiru is saying. Let us not rush. Let us just be careful that we have this sorted.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I am the Vice-Chairperson of the Committee.

3:54 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Of the Committee on Health?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, this is a Financial Bill—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What I have seen on the *Order Paper* is by the Minister for Health.

Mr Acheampong: The Minister for Health, Hon Mintah Akandoh, was invited; he was there. The Minister for Education was there; the Minister for Finance, including all the technocrats, were there. We met and took the decision. The Hon Member is a very good Friend of mine; he is a very serious person on the Committee, but on that particular day, he was not around.

This is the Report of the Committee; we met. If the Committee had not met, there is no way a Report could have been generated. So, he should admit that on that particular day, he attended a funeral in his Constituency. These are copies of the Report. I can give mine to him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think we can get to the root of this matter. I would be surprised if the Committee never met, and they were able to generate a Report, which would be laid in this House and ordered to be distributed to Members, and then the Clerks would proceed to programme the Bill for a Second Reading.

Dr T. A. K. Mahama: Mr Speaker, but I am quite young in this House, but customarily, before such Reports are laid, the Leadership of those Committees has the benefit of reading the Report. That is the first one. Let us assume for a moment that this Committee sat and looked at the Report and submitted the Report. We have not had the opportunity to even—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Who is the Ranking Member of the Committee?

Dr T. A. K. Mahama: The Ranking Member is Dr Mohammed Amin Adam, and I have his authority on this matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kabiru Mahama, this is a House of record. This is not a Question where you claim to have the authority of the person, and it will be taken lightly. If you place it on record and it turns out that the right has been done, it may constitute a matter of privileges, so we need to be very careful.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I just want to plead with Colleagues opposite. Following the uncapping and the decision to use 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) funds to invest in the MahamaCares, we in this Parliament passed a law which said that 20 per cent of the money should be used for non-communicable diseases. Then again, if they would recall they came here and we amended the Value Added Tax (VAT) Act in which we tried to confer some benefits if a person made the payments to make some tax deductible, and *et cetera*. So, what we are trying to do now is to go and clean the books in the parent legislation, which is a National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill.

It is not anything new that is being introduced. It is trying to sort out outstanding issues based on the work that we have already done as a Parliament. There are just a few amendments. Because we are all hoping that we can move fast and pass these things, so that, if possible, we can pass the Appropriation Bill early, and if possible,

Members can run to their Constituencies, and those who have international travels can embark on them. We are pleading with them so that we can just take this. It is just a few clauses, and it is not anything new.

So, I am pleading with them.

Ms Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, we do appreciate the appeal coming from the Majority Side but we have a difficulty. The difficulty is that we do not have a copy of the Report. There is no Report on the console. So, how do we deal with it? How can we accept —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minority Leader, I am reliably informed, and I can see a copy of the Report on the console.

Ms Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, I was here with the Clerk, and we were trying to find out where the Report was on the console. There was no — they just placed it on the console. One thing I do not like is that when people are wrongly accused for not being there when the meeting was held.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, in the circumstances, let us take—

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think in this matter their arrowhead is Hon Kabiru Mahama. He reads very fast, and I got an indication from him that we can continue. We will resolve our issues at home.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: However, let me take a one-and-a-half-minute suspension. That would give you the opportunity to digest the Report.

4:02 p.m. – *Sitting suspended.*

4:12 p.m. — *Sitting resumed.*

Hon Members, I believe strongly we have resolved the issue. Therefore, I will call on the Chairman of the Committee to move the Motion on the National Health Insurance Amendment Bill 2025 to be now read a Second time.

BILL — SECOND READING

National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) on behalf of the Minister for Finance: Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong) on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to present the Report of your Committee. I call on the *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as having been read as I touch on a few observations.

Introduction

The National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025 was presented

to Parliament by Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and read for the first time on Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

Subsequently, the Bill was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 226 of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Bill met with the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson; Hon Minister for Health, Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh; Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem; The Commissioner-General of the Ghana Revenue Authority, Mr Anthony Sarpong; officials from the Legislative Drafting Division of the Ministry of Justice and Attorney-General's Department; the technical team from the Ministry of Finance, Ministry of Health and Ghana Revenue Authority.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents in the consideration of the Bill:

- i. The 1992 Constitution
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii. National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852)

Rationale

The Government imposed the National Health Insurance Levy to provide dedicated funding for the National Health Insurance Scheme. The Levy is charged on the supply of goods and services in the Country, the importation of goods and the supply of an imported service other than exempt supplies and imports. The Levy is also applied in addition to the standard rate of the Value Added Tax. Currently, the Levy is not allowable as an input tax deduction, resulting in a cascading effect that increases the effective cost of goods and services for final consumers.

While the Levy has been a critical source of funding for the National Health Insurance Scheme, the non-deductibility of the Levy as an input tax has created compliance challenges for businesses and contributed to price distortions. These challenges have been highlighted as an impediment to the competitiveness of Ghana and have also increased the cost of doing business.

In the 2025 Budget Statement, the Government announced its intention to rationalise consumption taxes and streamline the Value Added Tax system by allowing input tax deductibility for earmarked levies. In line with the policy, the Bill seeks to amend the National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852) to make the National Health Insurance Levy fully input tax deductible.

Object of the Bill

The object of the Bill is to amend the National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852) to allocate 20 per cent of

moneys of the National Health Insurance Fund to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund and to allow for the deductibility of the National Health Insurance Levy.

Content of the Bill

The Bill contains seven clauses:

Clause 1 of the Bill amends section 42 of Act 852 by introducing a new subsection which provides for the allocation of twenty percent of moneys allocated to the Fund to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

Clause 2 of the Bill amends section 47 of Act 852 by imposing a National Health Insurance Levy on the supply of goods or services made in the country, other than exempt goods or services and import of goods or services. This, however, does not cover exempt imports.

Clause 3 of the Bill amends section 48 of Act 853 by exempting a supply in respect of a matter specified in the First Schedule to the Value Added Tax Act, 2013 (Act 870) from the Levy.

Clause 4 of the Bill amends section 49 of Act 852 by providing for zero-rated supply. The clause is to the effect that a supply in respect of a matter specified in the Second Schedule to the Value Added Tax Act, 2013 (Act 870) is subject to the Levy at a rate of zero per cent.

Clause 5 of the Bill amends section 50 of Act 852 to grant relief from the Levy to the individuals and organisations, and in respect of the matters specified in the Third Schedule to the Value Added Tax Act, 2013 (Act 870).

Clause 6 of the Bill amends section 51 of Act 852 on the collection of the Levy. The clause places the responsibility for the collection of the Levy on the Ghana Revenue Authority and also applies the Revenue Administration Act, 2016 (Act 915) to the administration of the Levy. The Value Added Tax Act, 2013 (Act 870) also applies with the necessary modifications to the collection of the Levy.

Clause 7 of the Bill amends section 109 of the Bill by providing for the definition for new phrases used in the Bill whilst clause 8 of the Bill provides for consequential amendment.

Observations and Recommendations

Dedicated Funding Source Supported by Legislation

The Committee observed that the amendment will provide a dedicated source of funding to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund by way of a legislation. As the House may be aware, the Ghana Medical Trust Fund was created to cater for the cost of care and medication for Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs) and other critical health conditions not currently included under the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS). It is also worth mentioning that the Fund will invest in health infrastructure, medical equipment, specialist training and research to enhance access to quality healthcare.

Business Competitiveness in Ghana

The Committee also observed that the amendment will reduce the cost of doing business and eliminate some other impediments to business competitiveness in the Country.

Proposed Amendment

Amendments proposed by the Committee during the consideration have been compiled and is attached as appendix.

Conclusion

The amendment will eliminate the cascading tax effect, enhance price transparency and reduce the tax burden on businesses. The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt its report and pass the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025.

Respectfully Submitted.

Question proposed.

4:22 p.m.

Dr Tiah Abdul Kabiru Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the matter before us has to do with the Health Insurance Act and the Health Insurance Levy. The Committee is proposing an amendment to set aside or to earmark, for lack of a better word, to cap the health insurance revenue by 20 per cent and use same for the purposes of taking care of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

Mr Speaker, the idea of the National Health Insurance was conceived and implemented by the former President, John Agyekum Kufuor. The President, though centre-right, was clear that we would need a social policy that would address the concerns of the vulnerable in society. The provision of health care was one of the tenets of his administration in which he wanted to ensure that every Ghanaian would have access to accessible and affordable health care.

Mr Speaker, when the National Health Insurance Scheme was implemented, there was the need for a legislation to have predictable funding sources. I am not saying this lightly. I am saying it because, when a government conceives a policy, that government equally must conceive sustainable funding sources for it. They do not throw a policy out and they are now rushing and scanning around to see where they can fund it.

Mr Speaker, the Health Insurance Levy was a dedicated funding source for the health insurance. Apart from that, the former President even added free maternal health care. These were social interventions and policies that were implemented.

Mr Speaker, over the years, health insurance has served the needs of Ghanaians. Before the health insurance, the cash and carry system was the most prevalent and that people were turned away from hospitals because they could not afford health care.

Mr Speaker, thank you to the President Agyekum Kufuor—that is now history. I even dare say that we do not even celebrate these people enough. A leader of that nature has taken away a major impediment from our health system.

Mr Speaker, but today, fast forward to 2025, we have a Bill. The Minister for Health brought the MahamaCares—the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. When they brought it, we told them that this Fund has no sustainable funding source for it and they said there was. At the end, the funding source was to cap the health insurance by 20 per cent and use that money to fund the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

Mr Speaker, the problem with such a system is that before this House, they have condemned Mr Ken Ofori-Atta for capping the health insurance. They argued that the health insurance nearly collapsed because it was capped. What has changed? Because the capping basically was taking money from health insurance and putting it in the centre and financing others. But this time around, they are capping it by 20 per cent and using the money to fund another programme. What is the difference between Ken Ofori-Atta and Dr Ato Forson?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, what is the other programme? Mention it for the record. Dr Kabiru, you know you are my very good Friend. But if you leave it, as “other programmes”, it is a bit vague. If you know the programme—

Mr T. A. K. Mahama: Mr Speaker, they are capping the health insurance to fund the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. How will you wake up and announce a programme without knowing where you want to fund it or without thinking outside the box to determine a funding source for it? Who does that? It is only under the Leadership of President John Mahama that one would find them announcing policies without even thinking about how they would fund it.

When President Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo introduced the Free Senior High School Programme, he was clear in his mind. He stated that if we are going to use the natural resources, the oil revenue of our country to fund education, it is a wasted investment. He was very clear in his mind. *[Interruption]* He was clear that he wanted to use the resources of our country to fund the Free Senior High School Programme. To that effect, he made sure that Annual Budget Funding Amount (ABFA), the resources that come from oil revenue to fund the Budget, is the allocation that he used to fund the Free Senior High School Programme. Yet, they argued that there was no funding for the Programme.

Even though that was done, their argument was that there was no funding for the Free Senior High School Programme. I am putting the same argument to them which is that, they introduced Ghana Medical Trust Fund and they are going to use the money for the health insurance to fund the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. That is the double standards we are talking about.

Mr Speaker, as politicians, sometimes we must be candid to the good people of Ghana. There is nothing wrong if Government tries to realign government funds to fund the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. But that should be put on record that they once told us that there was no funding source for Free Senior High School. They once mentioned that government did not have funding source for the Free Senior High School education. Meanwhile, they saw it in the Budget.

Next time, when they are on the political platforms or they rise before this House to talk, they should please remember that the Ghana Medical Trust Fund has no dedicated funding. They are using the money for the health insurance to fund it.

Mr Speaker, that said, the 20 per cent is going to pose a problem. Non-communicable diseases are a serious issue we are faced with. Every now and then, every single one of us has recourse from our constituents. They are on dialysis, doing kidney transplant and so on. The cost of this is too unbearable for even Members of Parliament (MP). The very last one I faced as an MP was a kidney transplant that required US\$35,000. I am not sure even the health insurance allowance or the project money they gave can suffice for that. Imagine if in your constituency, you have about five of them. How are you going to fund it?

This Ghana Medical Trust Fund catering for such related issues is a very noble idea. It is a good thing. However,

it is President John Agyekum Kufuor's funding source they are using to fund it. When it succeeds, they know who to give the credit to. When it fails, they know who the failure will go to. Because, we have provided them with funding sources with which they even bastardised and refused to give credit to. Now, they are using that to fund their MahamaCares programme.

President Mahama's Ghana Medical Trust Fund has no funding sources. They are using Mr John Agyekum Kufuor's funding source to fund it. I want *Hansard* to capture that for the purposes of emphasis. They will go around and say that they have introduced MahamaCares. *[Interruption]* In their next life, I hope they would change.

Mr Speaker, I will conclude on this note. The National Health Insurance Authority has complained. It is also facing its own problems and I want the Minister for Finance to think about it. Even with the 100 per cent, they are facing challenges. Now we are going to take 20 per cent out of the 100 per cent, leaving them with 80 per cent. It means that it also comes with its attendant challenges.

4:32 p.m.

Mr Speaker, this is coming on the back of the fact that there are increasing the payment of the premiums to service providers by 100 per cent or 200 per cent, if my memory serves me right. Or 200 per cent, if my memory serves me right. It means that more cost is coming to the Fund. So, we have to begin to think about

how we would then address any emerging challenges that will come following this decision to amend the Health Insurance Fund.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to support my Colleague that we consider this proposed amendment and that when they get away with this, I hope they will not sin again.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Cletus Seidu Dapilah?

Mr Cletus Seidu Dapilah (NDC — Jirapa): Mr Speaker, I want to make some few submissions. The first is that the Health Insurance and the 20 per cent of the Medical Trust Fund are moneys that will still be used for medical issues in the health sector. Unlike previously, the capping that was done, the money was sent to the Consolidated Fund account and it was used for various activities, including the National Cathedral which is the hole that they have dug.

Mr Speaker, all I want to say is that when we talk about policies or programmes without funding, the Hon Member of Parliament for Walewale should not have been the one to be saying this because they announced Free Senior High Education without funding source in this country. But in this case, what we are doing is that the 20 per cent is money that is still meant for the health sector. It is to solve health problems and not any other problems.

So, for them to make this submission, it is good we let them know that the money — and let me also add that when we uncap the Fund, we will be doing GH¢9.9 billion in 2026. If we are taking part of it to still solve health-related issues, I think it is still not out of place and the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) is doing 62 per cent increase in funding. So, they need to support it and not argue the way they are arguing.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Fred Kyei Asamoah?

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (NPP — Offinso North): Mr Speaker, thank you very much. As I contribute to the debate, I want to make four things very clear. The National Democratic Congress' (NDC) Manifesto talked about uncapping the National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL). It also talked about the Ghana Medical Trust Fund for non-communicable diseases. Then it talked about free primary healthcare from CHPS compounds to polyclinics. It also talked about expanding health infrastructure.

Mr Speaker, unfortunately, uncapping the National Health Insurance is something that we all support. But we were expecting that this uncapping and the extra fund, that 20 per cent, could have gone into expansion of medical infrastructure, health training, vaccines, and the rest. Unfortunately, it is not happening. For me, it is like robbing Ghanaians or Peter to pay Paul. The 20

per cent that we are taking from the uncapping of the National Health Insurance Fund is what we are using to pay for the Medical Trust Fund. It is just renaming and it is like trying to cut one's own tongue to chew. We are just renaming the same Fund.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, do we agree that the diseases that are covered under Ghana Medical Trust Fund is also a health concern that needs to be addressed?

Dr Asamoah: Mr Speaker, exactly so. That is why when we are talking about—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, do you not agree with me that this is quite different from, for instance, capping the National Health Insurance to support sports?

Dr Asamoah: Mr Speaker, I know you would not want to debate with me but contribute to the discussion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am not contributing. I want our contribution to be clear to the general public. Because if you said to use it for other things, it creates the impression as if whatever they are going to use it for is not health in nature.

Dr Asamoah: Mr Speaker, if the House remembers correctly, during the Medical Trust Fund debate, I stated, where does the NHIS end? Where does the Medical Trust Fund end? And where does the primary healthcare end? That is why we are saying that it is a matter of

improving on the National Health Insurance. Because non-communicable disease is also a disease and in managing it, is a matter of systems.

Mr Speaker, remember the Medical Trust fund that we have set up, we are also going to set up a system that has to interface with the National Health Insurance. It is also extra cost; it is just renaming. So, in the first place, the Medical Trust Fund was not needed; it is a matter of improving on the National Health Insurance because primary care deals with prevention, and managing normal diseases and they are non-communicable. It is a stream; diseases do not end anywhere. We cannot end one part. So, we believe that it is just a matter of renaming that is happening here. We would hope that the uncapping of the National Health Insurance should rather commit extra funds because we want to improve on primary healthcare. We could commit those funds to be able to take care of entire primary healthcare and non-communicable diseases.

Mr Speaker, unfortunately, the 20 per cent that was uncapped in 2025, what has happened to those funds? What has been spent? They need to do a proper update of how we spend those funds before we add on. Also, have we got a proper costing of the Medical Trust Fund? No, we have not been able to cost it properly, but we are saying we are taking 20 per cent. We have asked these questions and all the questions that we asked during the debate are coming back to bite us.

So, I support the call that it is just renaming of one fund that we are trying

to cut into pieces to rename parts of it. Why can we not improve on the National Health Insurance system instead of having another system that will be forced by bringing actuaries to be able to see how these systems will interact?

Mr Speaker, I believe that the Government needs to commit more funds. We need to have more funds towards health. Because even with the Budget we have for 2026, we are still below the recommended international standards. So, what we are asking is that in as much as we are supporting it, it will be good that the uncapping should rather be fully committed to the National Health Insurance and find another source to commit to the Medical Trust Fund.

Mr Speaker, with this, I support the Bill. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Felix Kwakye Ofori?

Mr Felix Kwakye Ofori (NDC — Abura-Asebu-Kwamankese): Mr Speaker, I lend full support to the efforts to amend the National Health Insurance Act to reflect the changes that this Government has introduced.

Mr Speaker, there are a few misconceptions that must be cleared even as we work towards passing these amendments. The first is that it is untrue that taking a part of the National Health Insurance money and channelling same into the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, popularly known as “MahamaCares”, means that there was no funding source. The National Health Insurance Levy is a

funding source. The truth is that unlike when they capped the NHIS and diverted the funds into as yet unknown expenditure, this time, we have been upfront to the people of Ghana and they know exactly where the funds we are taking out of the NHIS will go to.

Can Hon Dr Mahama tell us what they used the money they capped the NHIS for? If we said today that they used it to build the National Cathedral, can he dispute it? He does not know but let me make my point. He mentioned President Kufuor’s name, has he responded to what you said?

4:42 p.m.

Mr Speaker, unlike them who operated opaquely, we have been transparent. They have said that MahamaCares was a key manifesto promise, so I wonder why they would have a problem with its delivery.

Mr Speaker, if the NHIS money is used to finance a health-related activity, it is in order, because chronic diseases or non-communicable diseases have become a major issue. The NHIL, as it is currently structured, is unable to take on the load, so a special dispensation needed to be created to address this.

Mr Speaker, the people of Ghana are exceedingly excited that the financial burdens that they used to incur would be addressed through the establishment of MahamaCares and the use of some GH¢2.3 billion to address them.

Mr Speaker, it is also not true that we have not made provision for health infrastructure. When my Brother spoke,

he said that he thought that the money we were taking from the NHIS would go into health infrastructure. When the Hon Minister for Finance came to this House and read the Budget, he indicated that three regional hospitals are going to be constructed in the regions that do not have them, especially because they created six regions and made no provision for such infrastructure.

Again, my Brother is fully aware that the guidelines that were put together to govern the disbursement of the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) have a provision for at least two Community-based Health Planning and Services (CHPS) compounds for every district. So, we are talking in excess of 500 CHPS compounds that will be constructed once the guideline is adhered to; I am aware that the work is currently ongoing. At least, in the Abura-Asebu-Kwamankese (AAK) District, we are on the verge of completing the two CHPS compounds, which are vital health infrastructure for people who live in rural communities. It is also a key plank of the strategy to introduce free primary health care, because that was also a major campaign promise. Free primary health care would normally take place in a CHPS compound up to about a polyclinic. So, those claims cannot hold.

Finally, the notion that the NHIS was implemented under President Kufuor is not entirely true. We know that the pilot started under the Rawlings' Administration. They left Mutual Health Insurance Schemes. It was the NHIS Act of 2012, which is captured in this report, that made it national.

Mr Speaker, on sources of funding, was it not two and a half per cent of Value Added Tax (VAT) that they used to finance the expanded NHIS? Who introduced VAT?

An Hon Member: You were a school boy!

Mr Oforu: I was not a school boy. I fully understand that they took money from VAT, the same VAT that they staged the *Kume Preko* demonstrations against. So, talking about taking money from sources that already exist, they are the guilty party. I wonder why they have a problem with a government that is seeking to streamline health financing to alleviate one of the biggest problems that we have in this country, which is non-communicable diseases. So, those records must be set straight.

With those few words, Mr Speaker, I am on all fours with the efforts to ensure that the MahamaCares programme is adequately funded to the benefit of the people of Ghana.

I thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members should take note that when they choose to respond to matters that are not on record, their response will be captured on record; that is the risk. You speak to matters that are not on record, but your response will be captured on the record, and if tomorrow somebody is reading the *Hansard*, you know the person's mind against whoever placed those things on record.

Yes, Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I want to thank you for this opportunity. I want to respectfully comment on this Report. By doing so, I want to make a reference to the object of the Bill, which says, and I read:

“The object of the Bill is to amend the National Health Insurance Act, 2012, Act 852, to allocate 20 per cent of the monies of the National Health Insurance Fund to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, and to allow deductibility of the National Health Insurance Levy.”

Mr Speaker, my question is simple: why are we amending and taking money from the National Health Insurance, just for the purposes of running another medical trust fund? And why do we need a trust fund in the first place when the National Health Insurance has been active and effective.

Mr Speaker, in 2003, President Kufuor mooted the idea of getting the National Health Insurance, and it was vehemently opposed by our Brothers on this Side. It was opposed to the extent that they did not want to know what he was going to cover.

Mr Speaker, in 2007, we were in Ghana when we came promising that we were going to have a one-time premium. What happened to the one-time premium? It vanished with the fire that it deserved, and nobody talked about the one-time premium.

Mr Speaker, currently, the Ghana Health Information Management System (GHIMS) is not working. When we go to the medical centres in Ghana, the doctors will say that they do not have records of the patients; they do not. What is currently operating is the cash and carry system —

Mr Ahi — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Sampson Ahi, Hon Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry, why are you up?

Mr Ahi: Mr Speaker, my Colleague said that in 2003, President Kufuor introduced health insurance. President Kufuor never introduced health insurance. President Kufuor introduced Mutual Health Insurance, which restricted beneficiaries to particular districts. If one is registered at Juaboso district, one is supposed to use it only in Juaboso.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Sampson Ahi, which Order are you coming under?

Mr Ahi: Mr Speaker, Order 122(1).
[Laughter]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Order 122 allows you to interrupt the debate based on certain conditions. Which of the conditions are you invoking?

Mr Ahi: Mr Speaker, can you allow me to flow? Mr Speaker, can you allow me to flow? Order 122(1)(c) says that, “Debate may be interrupted by a point of information, elucidation or clarification.”

4:52 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Ahi, you are right. Please, you have the floor. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Ahi: Mr Speaker, my Colleague said that in 2003, former President Kufuor introduced the Health Insurance Scheme, and I am saying that that is factually incorrect. President Kufuor, in 2003, introduced the Mutual Health Insurance Scheme. Professor Mills introduced the National Health Insurance, which made it possible—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kabiru and Hon Jerry, there are no rules that allow you to take a point of order against a point of order.

Hon Sampson Ahi, you have the floor.

Mr Ahi: We need to set the record straight; President Kufuor introduced the Mutual Health Insurance Scheme. He never introduced the National Health Insurance Scheme. Because at that time, if one was from Juaboso and registered as a Mutual Health Insurance Scheme member, one could not use it in the North district. One could not use it in the Bibiani district. One could not use it in Kumasi or anywhere else in the country, except in Juaboso. Professor Mills established the National Health Insurance Scheme, which allowed anyone who registered in Juaboso, regardless of where they were in the country — One could go to Nungua Hospital and access health insurance services.

So, Hon Jerry and Dr Kabiru should be advised. If they do not know, this is what happened. The NPP never introduced the National Health Insurance Scheme. They introduced the Mutual Health Insurance Scheme. They should be guided accordingly. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Jerry Ahmed, you were on the floor. Take the information provided and then proceed accordingly.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, it is unfortunate that we allowed my respected Senior to perpetuate untruths on this matter. I know he has been in this House for a long time, and therefore ought to have known that the Ghana National Health Insurance Scheme Act 650 was officially established by law in 2003. They should take note, and when they go home, they should revise their notes on that. Let me proceed with my germane issues. If they do not have the information, they should please go and check and stop disrupting proceedings unnecessarily.

Mr Speaker, we are here today to let them understand that if they want to just implement campaign promises without considering the general well-being of the people, we would always come back to square one. I have indicated in this House that we have also heard past presidents make promises, including a one-time premium that we cannot find anywhere. From Kpandai to Ledzokuku, we cannot find that one-time premium. When one goes to Walewale, there is no

one-time premium. When one goes to their constituency, there is nothing like a one-time premium.

We are dealing with a lot of problems with reference to those who are working in the health sector. Our nurses have not been paid for close to seven months. Mr Speaker, more than 120,000 people who applied to be nurses have not been taken. As I speak, more than 12,000 people's jobs within the health sector were revoked; their appointments were revoked. But they found the need to establish a Ghana Medical Trust Fund, rushing just to fulfil a certain campaign promise. And do we know what is happening? They are taking 20 per cent of the money from the National Health Insurance that they seriously and vehemently opposed, which Kufuor brought to the fore, to support another fund, when they know that, whether it is a communicable disease or any other disease, they would have had the same and better treatment under the National Health Insurance.

What are we doing? What are we looking for? Why are we being discriminatory in everything we do? Why are we pursuing propaganda anywhere and everywhere? Mr Speaker, one has the opportunity, right now, to pay when one goes to any medical facility. I raised this issue two weeks ago: when one goes to any medical facility, one pays before one is treated. When a pregnant woman wants to deliver through caesarean section, she pays. It is between GH¢5,000 and 9,000. They are not solving all of these problems. They have just sent a paltry

amount of money to say that they are taking care of Agenda 111 projects. What are we doing to ourselves? As we speak, when one goes to the Weija-Gbawe paediatric hospital, which is new and almost complete, it has not been commissioned. They have rather left it to go and do what? Ghana Medical Trust Fund?

In the whole of Greater Accra, the only children's hospital is the Princess Marie Louise Children's Hospital. What is stopping us from prosecuting this infrastructure, the Agenda 111? What is stopping us from working on the Weija-Gbawe Paediatric Hospital? What is stopping us? All we see is that we come back to the usual politics. I believe we should think this through thoroughly. Agenda 111 is a project that, when completed, will benefit the Ghanaian people. If we can extend the National Health Insurance to cover communicable diseases, there is absolutely nothing wrong with that. What is right with it is that it is already working and working well. So, we can now expand.

As I speak with you, a lot of the staff from the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) have been taken to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. To do what? What are they going to do? If we have the capacity, why are we taking people from the National Health Insurance Authority and sending them to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund? *ɔmo kɔɔ ho kɔ yɛ dɔn? Mɔni amɔ mli yaa ni amɔya fee yɛ dzɔmɔ?* To wit, what are they going to do there? They are already at the National Health Insurance Authority. They have their well-assigned roles and

responsibilities. All we are doing is propaganda. Perpetrate propaganda; Left, right, propaganda. Wherever one passes, propaganda. Why? Why do we want to feed on propaganda? Is everything going to be propaganda for the Ghanaian people to suffer? Stop the propaganda and do the work.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to thank you for giving me this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor (NDC — South Dayi): Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to set the record straight.

Mr Speaker, Act 650 provided explicitly for a District Mutual Health Insurance Scheme. Section 11 (a) of the law created a District Mutual Health Insurance Scheme for the benefit of the members of the district. Section 104, which is the — Please.

Mr Speaker, I was very quiet and listened to them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Tobbin, why do you take delight in speaking across? Your voice is so loud. It is part of what game? Is it part of the Second Reading? Please.

5:02 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in Section 104 of that law, which is the interpretation section, Mutual Health

Insurance Scheme was defined as follows. Mr Speaker, with your leave, let me read:

“Mutual Health Insurance Scheme means a community-based health insurance composed of members of the community in the relevant districts and operated exclusively for the benefit of the members.”

Mr Speaker, what the Hon Sampson Ahi said was actually the accurate set of facts. Act 852 was what actually established the National Health Insurance Scheme. The 2003 Act may have carried the nomenclature ‘National’, but the beneficiaries were persons who were limited only to utilising the benefits in the district from which they originated. It is Act 852 that made it national, which made a beneficiary to benefit from the scheme wherever he found himself in this country. Those are the material differences between the two enactments. Mr Speaker, with these words, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Dr Kabiru, with all due respect, unless you are able to show me the basis for which you should be given the second chance to speak on this issue, I will not grant you the floor. During debates, you would have to speak once on the matter.

Dr T. A. K. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I seek your leave to correct—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kabiru, I am inclined not to grant the leave, so I kindly resume your seat.

Yes, Deputy Minister for Finance?

Deputy Minister for Finance (Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker. The object of this Bill is to do two main things. One of them is to allocate 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance Levy to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. The second one is to remove the cascading effect by treating the Ghana Health Insurance Levy as a straight-line levy without the input tax deductions. Mr Speaker, a lot has been said. In fact, listening to the debate, they tried to shift the focus and talk about all sorts of things. But I just want to bring us back to the object of the Bill and why we should do this.

Mr Speaker, if you look at the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act which was passed by this House this year, we, under sources of money to the Fund, decided that we would allocate 20 per cent of total moneys allocated to the National Health Insurance Fund to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. So, it is this House that took the decision. We have decided that because the Ghana Medical Trust Fund has already stated that 20 per cent of the Health Insurance Fund should be allocated to it, we should reflect the decision of this House in the amendment of the Health Insurance Act. We are only doing the same thing that this House has passed.

On the other leg, yesterday, when we took turns to debate the treatment of the GETFund Levy, we made the statement, and I want to reiterate, that the decision to reverse their decision in 2018 to treat the Health Insurance Levy as a straight-

line levy and to disallow input and output tax deductions cost taxpayers dearly. Because of that, we are reversing it to give some space to taxpayers. This is costing us; we are losing revenue. More than GH¢1.7 billion of revenue will be lost because of that. But it is a deliberate decision to give back to taxpayers.

In conclusion, Mr Speaker, Hon Kabiru made some statements, trying to compare the Ministers for Finance. He asked the question that what is the difference between Ken Ofori Atta and Ato Forson? The difference is clear. One of them took inflation to 54 per cent, and the other one has brought inflation down to 6.3 per cent. One of them depreciated the Ghana cedi to the extent that the dollar was selling at GH¢17. Today, the other person has reduced it, has strengthened the dollar to GH¢11.4. Dr Mahama, your Minister for Finance actually reduced our credit ratings to a junk status. The other one has actually caused our credit ratings to be raised to—*[Interruption]* So, the difference is clear. Never compare the two of them. It is actually a blasphemous statement to compare the two of them because they are not comparable.

For one of them, success was judged by borrowing and throwing kenkey party. The other one was to manage prudently without even borrowing. So, Mr Speaker, I want to encourage all of us to support this amendment because it is the right thing to do in the interest of Mother Ghana. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before putting the Question, it

is important to draw the House's attention to an observable fact that during the Second Reading, we are deviating from what we are supposed to do within the meaning of Standing Order 167. Hon Members, the Constitution demands that every Bill should be accompanied by a Memorandum. At Second Reading of the Bill, since the Memorandum explains the principle, the rationale, the mischief and what the Bill actually seeks to do, our debate at the Second Reading is centred along that side. It is not about who introduced the National Health Insurance Trust or National Health Insurance Scheme. This is not about taking part of the National Health Insurance Trust Fund to Ghana Medical Trust Fund; it is the same as capping and realignment. This is not all about that. It is not about the use of part of the National Health Insurance to National Health Insurance Trust is better than the construction of the National Cathedral. I believe we are debating the principles. We are not doing a political debate.

Order 167 states:

“When a Motion is moved “that a Bill be now read a Second Time”, a full debate shall ensue on the basis of the explanatory memorandum and the report from the relevant Committee.”

5:12 p.m.

So, the debate should be governed by the memorandum accompanying the Bill, as well as the report from the Committee. I have not seen us doing that,

but we take it that it is a period to do usual politics. Going forward, I advise that we should restrict ourselves to Standing Order 167, and talk about the Bill on the basis of the Explanatory Memoranda, and the report presented by the Committee.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025 accordingly read a Second time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, can we now look at the item numbered 32, Consideration Stage.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025 at the Consideration Stage.

Hon Members, before moving to the clauses, indulge me to recognise the presence of winners of 2025 National Public Speaking Competition, organised by Deedee Global in partnership with Ghana Education Service, under the auspices of the Office of the Speaker of Parliament.

The students or the schools that took part in the competition are Sunyani Senior High School, Accra Academy, Osei Tutu Boys Senior High School, Swedru Senior High School, and Bechem Presbyterian Senior High School. They are led by Bertha Amanor, who happens to be the National Public Speaking Competition, Ghana Coordinator.

They all numbered 142. On your behalf, I welcome all of them and congratulate them for winning the various awards. May you have a very fruitful visit to Parliament Chamber.

[Participants of the National Public Speaking Competition were acknowledged.]

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Clause 1 – Section 42 of Act 852 amended.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed – *delete*.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 1 *deleted*.

Clause 2 – Section 47 of Act 852 amended.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, before I move for the consideration of the proposed amendment to clause 2, I want to correct item 5. If we look at the advertised amendment, it reads, “The Minister for Finance”. So, we have cancelled it and in place of that, “Parliament shall allocate”. This is because it is the duty of Parliament to allocate the resources.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Member, move the amendment in clause 2, and in doing so, you further amend clause 2 (5).

Mr Acheampong: So, Mr Speaker, amendment proposed – *Delete and insert* the following:

“Section 47 of Act 852 amended

The National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852), referred to in this Act as the “principal enactment” is amended by the substitution for section 47, of

Imposition of National Health Insurance Levy

47. (1) There is imposed by this Act, a National Health Insurance Levy on the

(a) supply of goods or services made in the country, other than exempt goods or services; and

(b) import of goods or services other than exempt imports.

(2) The rate of the Levy is two and a half per cent.

(3) The Levy shall be paid at the time the goods or services are supplied or imported.

(4) Except as otherwise provided in this Act, the Levy is charged on the supply of goods and services where the supply is

(a) a taxable supply; and

(b) made by a taxable person in the course of the taxable activity of that person.

(5) The Minister for Finance shall allocate twenty per cent of the revenue generated from the National Health Insurance Levy to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.”

In so doing, I amend Clause 2 (5). I replace “The Minister responsible...”, with “Parliament”. Respectfully submitted, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the amendment to clause 2 seeks to *delete* and *insert* the following. Now, in inserting the following, it is further amended in clause 2 (5) to *delete* “The Minister for Finance” and “insert” Parliament. So, the new rendition will be “Parliament shall allocate twenty per cent of the revenue generated from National Health Insurance Levy to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund”. Any further amendment?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 2 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 4 and 6 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 7, at the marginal note states: ‘Section 109 of Act 852 amended’. However, the provision says the principal enactment is amended in section 100. I believe the section 100 should be section 109. So, Chairman of the Committee, own the amendment and let us make progress.

5:22 p.m.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, can you take it again? I was not following.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I said if you look at the marginal note, it states: ‘Section 109 of Act 852 amended.’ So, the section to be amended in the interpretation is “section 109”. But the clause is saying that the principal enactment is amended in section 100, so section 100 should be corrected to read “section 109”.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, the amendment proposed, section 109 of Act 852 be amended, not 100.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you are amending 100.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, *delete* 100, and *insert* 109.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal is to *delete* 100 after section and before by, and *insert* 109.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 7 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Long Title?

Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the main provision that we are amending speaks of

the allocation of revenue generated from the National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL) to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. If you go to the Long Title, it states:

“AN ACT to amend the National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852) to allocate twenty per cent of moneys of the National Health Insurance Fund to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, to allow for the deduction of the National Health Insurance Levy and to provide for related matters.”

Initially, I thought that since we were allocating 20 per cent of the revenue generated from the National Health Insurance Levy to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, the Long Title should reflect that and say, “an Act to amend the National Health Insurance Act to allocate 20 per cent of monies of the National Health Insurance Levy to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund”. The same way as it is captured in the main amendment. But I just checked the parent Act: the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, and I noticed that it states, “20 per cent of the fund.”

So, I think we should drop it and allow the current rendition of the Long Title to remain. This is because that is how it is in the parent legislation, which is the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you are no longer carrying out the amendment?

Mr Ayariga: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Then we have to go back and look at clause 2(5), which says 20 per cent of the health insurance levy, and then change the levy accordingly to fund. Clause 2(5) states: “... 20 per cent of the revenue generated from the National Health Insurance Levy to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund”.

So, Hon Minister, in view of the fact that the Long Title is going to stay, which is categorically talking about 20 per cent of the entire — Yes, let us debate this here —

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we need to be careful because fund is not the same as levy. A levy is a specific amount of tax, but a fund is a basket that holds both a levy and other sources of revenue accruing to —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The question is, are you talking about 20 per cent of the Levy, which is a component of the Fund, or are you talking about 20 per cent of the Fund?

Mr Ayariga: But in the legislation — the Minister is here. In the legislation, it is obvious that the intention of the Minister is that it is a levy. 20 per cent of the levy should be assigned to —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In the previous law, was it 20 per cent of the Fund, or 20 per cent of the Levy?

Mr Ayariga: It actually said 20 per cent of the Fund.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, if it is 20 per cent of the Fund, and if we are not careful, and we use levy here, then whatever law that we are passing will be inconsistent with the previous one that is already passed.

Mr Ayariga: Yes, so we were discussing the need for us to check the repealed provisions in the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, to see if we will be doing the right thing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, in the circumstances, I would put a question and direct the draftsman to reconcile the law, and it will have a consequential effect on whether it should be a fund or a levy. So that throughout the law, if it is a levy, then we apply the levy. If it is a fund, then we apply the fund consequentially, and if it is a fund, then we apply the fund consequentially.

Yes, Hon Deputy Minister for Finance?

5:32 p.m.

Mr Ampem: Mr Speaker, you have concluded, and I support your conclusion, except that I just want to draw our attention—When we say the levy, then it is 20 per cent of only the 2.5 per cent National Health Insurance Levy that will be transferred to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. There are other sources of funds to the National Health Insurance. For instance, there is a percentage of SSNIT that also goes to the Fund. So, if we say the whole Fund, then

it is 20 per cent of the total funds to the National Health Insurance that will go to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. I feel that the contemplation is 20 per cent of the Levy, but the confusion is that we need to be sure what the Ghana Medical Trust Fund says. If it says 20 per cent of all the funds to the National Health Insurance, then we have to be consistent.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, in the circumstances, whether the word should be a “Levy” or a “Fund”, I will direct that they should look at what is in the existing law, and then apply it consequentially. I so direct the draft persons. So draft persons, take note.

The Long Title ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that brings us to the end of the Consideration Stage of the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Bill, 2025, and on that note, I would advise that we defer the Third Reading of the Bill, subject to the reconciliation by the draftpersons.

Thank you very much.

Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader, any indication?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Mr Speaker, I do not think we have spent five hours yet, so I want to move that the House adjourns till Tuesday at midday.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, there is a Motion for adjournment. Any seconder?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, save that we are not sure whether we are dealing with fund or levy, and the confusion that is brewing— It is very critical. They are not sure whether they are dealing with fund or levy, considering the huge amount, but they still want to adjourn. Consider the issues critically before we go home.

Mr Speaker, yesterday you were able to handle three shifts alone; one man, three shifts, which means that the 24-Hour Economy itself is going out of coverage area—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, I have the energy, so if you are willing to work, subject to the convenience, if there are items, bring it. We can close at 3:00 a.m.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, we are willing to work, but they are 38 in number. Mr Speaker, but for the deference I have for you, I would have

insisted on raising the issue of quorum. *[Uproar]* Mr Speaker, they are 38 in number. But all that said—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, you know that because of our relationship, I was compelled to place on record that you are my sixth form classmate at Keta Secondary School, indicative of the fact that you are my very good Friend. So, will you humbly second the Motion for adjournment?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, because of this very beautiful relationship, and seeing the excitement on the Deputy Majority Leader's face, although he does not have the numbers, I second the Motion that the House be adjourned.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 5:32 p.m. till Tuesday 16th December, 2025 at 12:00 noon.

Editor's Note

This Official Report was corrected by the House on 18th December, 2025.